

PyPSA-IEI

Documentation

Integrated Energy Infrastructure Model

Open Energy Transition

None

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1. PyPSA-IEI Documentation

PyPSA-IEI is an energy-system model based on the open-source [PyPSA-Eur](#) framework (release 0.10), extended to meet the needs of the study:

"Integrated Infrastructure Planning and 2050 Climate Neutrality: Deriving Future-Proof European Energy Infrastructures" — Fraunhofer IEG, Fraunhofer ISI and d-fine (November 2025)

[Download report \(PDF\)](#)

1.1 About the Model

PyPSA-IEI performs **myopic pathway optimisation** of the European energy system across multiple planning horizons between 2020 and 2050 in 5 year increments. It co-optimizes the electricity, hydrogen, gas, heat, and industry sectors within an integrated framework to identify the least-cost configuration of the overall energy system.

Key extensions on top PyPSA-Eur v0.10 include:

- TYNDP-based electricity and gas network enforcement
 - Hydrogen network (European Hydrogen Backbone + ENTSO-G)
 - Energy import modelling (hydrogen, syngas, synfuel)
 - TransHyDe-based industrial demand
 - Custom cost assumptions and powerplant lifetimes
-

1.2 Quick Links

- [Installation](#) — set up the environment and input data
 - [Scenarios](#) — overview of the four main policy scenarios (CE, CN, SE, SN)
 - [Model Functionality](#) — detailed description of model extensions
-

1.3 Contributors

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2. Installation

2.1 Requirements

- **Git** — for cloning the repository (**Windows:** [Git for Windows](#) is recommended, which also includes **Git Bash**)
- **Conda** (Miniconda or Anaconda) — for environment management
- **Gurobi** — a commercial solver licence is required to run the model locally. If you do not have a Gurobi licence, use the [OETC Cloud Solver](#) instead.

2.2 1. Clone the Repository

```
git clone https://github.com/open-energy-transition/PyPSA-IEI.git
cd PyPSA-IEI
```

Working directory

All Snakemake commands in this guide must be run from inside the `PyPSA-IEI/` directory. The `cd PyPSA-IEI` above puts you there after cloning. If you open a new terminal, run:

```
cd /path/to/PyPSA-IEI
```

2.3 2. Download Input Data

This repository only contains input data explicitly developed for this study. The following files must be copied from [PyPSA-Eur v0.10.0 \(February 19, 2024\)](#) into the `data/` folder of this repository:

```
pypsa-eur/          ← source repository
└─ data/
   ├── GDP_PPP_30arcsec_v3_mapped_default.csv
   ├── switzerland-new_format-all_years.csv
   └── urban_percent.csv
```

Additional data will be automatically retrieved by Snakemake rules during the first run.

Note

The data used to generate the study results were downloaded on **June 27th 2024**.

2.4 3. Set Up the Environment

Create and activate the conda environment using the file matching your operating system:

Windows **Linux**

```
conda env create -f envs/environment_pypsa_iei.yaml
conda activate pypsa-ie

conda env create -f envs/environment_pypsa_iei_linux.yaml
conda activate pypsa-ie
```

For detailed instructions on setting up PyPSA-Eur, refer to the [official documentation](#).

2.5 4. Run a Scenario

Results for the study were generated across four main scenarios and four sensitivities. Choose the track that matches your situation:

2.5.1 Track 1 — Pipeline Test (Low-End Machine)

This track is designed for running the model on a low-end or Windows machine, or for anyone who wants to verify the full pipeline works end-to-end before committing to a full run. The goal is to test the workflow, not to reproduce study results. Indicative requirements per scenario:

Configuration	RAM	Cores	Time
20SEG-T-H-B-I-A (recommended reduced-resolution test)	>16 GB	4	~1.5-2 hours
20SEG (electricity-only fallback, limited downstream compatibility in post-analysis)	>16 GB	4	~1.5-2 hours

No local solver?

If you do not have a Gurobi licence or prefer to offload solving, see the [OETC Cloud Solver](#) section below.

Which config to use for testing?

Use `config.SE.yaml` for pipeline testing. It has fewer custom constraints and works correctly even when sector suffixes (T, H, B, I, A) are omitted. `config.SN.yaml` enables self-sufficiency constraints that require industry sector components (e.g. Fischer-Tropsch links) to be present — running it without the I suffix will cause an error.

Step 1 — Reduce the temporal resolution

Edit `sector_opts` in your scenario config to use fewer time segments while keeping the sector suffixes enabled:

```
# config/scenarios/config.SE.yaml
scenario:
  sector_opts:
    - 20SEG-T-H-B-I-A # reduced from 2190SEG - much faster, less memory
```

This is the recommended Track 1 setup. It keeps the workflow closer to the full study configuration and avoids downstream issues in summary generation and post-analysis scripts that can appear with electricity-only runs.

If you only want the lightest possible smoke test, you can still omit the sector suffixes entirely:

```
scenario:
  sector_opts:
    - 20SEG
```

However, this electricity-only variant should be treated as a minimal pipeline check only. Later postprocessing and analysis steps are more likely to **fail with an electricity-only model**.

Warning

Reduced-segment results are **not comparable** to the study. Electricity-only runs are even more limited and are mainly useful for quick smoke tests.

Step 2 — Dry run (recommended)

Verify that Snakemake can resolve all rules and inputs before executing anything:

```
~/PyPSA-IEI$ snakemake -call all --configfile config/scenarios/config.SE.yaml --dry-run
```

Step 3 — Run the full workflow

Use the `all` target so the full pipeline runs and the summary outputs needed for later analysis are generated. Start with as many cores as your machine can handle:

```
~/PyPSA-IEI$ snakemake -call all --configfile config/scenarios/config.SE.yaml
```

If you are on Windows, you can still start with the `all` target as shown above. If the workflow later becomes unstable when it reaches `solve_sector_networks`, see [Troubleshooting](#) and resume the same target with `--cores 1`.

Once the run completes, see [Verifying Success](#) to confirm the output files are in place. If you run into issues, see the [Troubleshooting](#) section.

2.5.2 Track 2 — Full Study Run

This track reproduces the study results. It requires a machine with sufficient memory (approximately **250 GB of RAM**) and compute time (approximately **2.5 days** per scenario).

Step 1 — Dry run (recommended)

Before launching the full run, verify that Snakemake can resolve all rules and inputs without executing anything:

```
~/PyPSA-IEI$ snakemake -call all --configfile config/scenarios/config.SN.yaml --dry-run
```

This prints the list of jobs that would be executed. If any rule or input file is missing, the error appears here — before committing hours of compute time.

Step 2 — Run all steps with the full configuration:

```
~/PyPSA-IEI$ snakemake -call all --configfile config/scenarios/config.SN.yaml
```

Note

The study uses **2190 time segments** (2190SEG) with all sector suffixes (-T-H-B-I-A). Do not modify `sector_opts` if you want results comparable to the publication.

Warning

On Windows, the workflow may become unstable once it reaches `solve_sector_networks`. Start with as many cores as you want, but if the solve stage fails, resume with `--cores 1` as described in [Troubleshooting](#).

2.5.3 Verifying Success

Snakemake prints the following when all jobs complete without errors:

```
X of X steps (100%) done
```

For each planning horizon (2020–2050), a solved network file should appear under `results/<run_name>/postnetworks/`. The exact filename depends on your track:

Track	Example postnetwork file
Track 1 — 20SEG-T-H-B-I-A	<code>elec_s_62_lv99_20SEG-T-H-B-I-A_2020.nc</code>
Track 2 — 2190SEG-T-H-B-I-A	<code>elec_s_62_lv99_2190SEG-T-H-B-I-A_2050.nc</code>

If any files are missing, check the corresponding log file under `logs/` for the failing rule.

For further details on running PyPSA-Eur-based models, refer to the [open-source documentation](#).

If you run into issues, see the [Troubleshooting](#) section.

2.5.4 OETC Cloud Solver (Optional — Skip Local Solving)

If you prefer not to run the solver locally — whether because of hardware limitations or to save time — the solving step can be offloaded to the Open Energy Transition Cloud (OETC). This works with both Track 1 and Track 2. Network preparation always runs locally; only the solve step is offloaded.

Step 1 — Enable OETC in your scenario config:

The `oetc` block is already present in `config/config.agora.yaml` with OETC disabled by default. To enable it, add the following override to your scenario config:

```
# config/scenarios/config.SE.yaml (or any other scenario file)
solving:
  oetc:
    enabled: true
```

Note

Set `enabled: false` or omit the override entirely to fall back to the local solver.

Step 2 — Set your OETC credentials as environment variables:

Linux Windows (Git Bash) Windows (PowerShell)

Add to your `~/.bashrc` (or `~/.bash_profile`) for a persistent setup:

```
nano ~/.bashrc    # or: vi ~/.bashrc
```

Append these lines:

```
export OETC_EMAIL="your@email.com"
export OETC_PASSWORD="yourpassword"
```

Then reload and verify:

```
source ~/.bashrc
echo $OETC_EMAIL
```

Add to your `~/.bashrc` :

```
nano ~/.bashrc    # or: vi ~/.bashrc
```

Append these lines:

```
export OETC_EMAIL="your@email.com"
export OETC_PASSWORD="yourpassword"
```

Then reload and verify:

```
source ~/.bashrc
echo $OETC_EMAIL
```

For the current session only:

```
$env:OETC_EMAIL = "your@email.com"
$env:OETC_PASSWORD = "yourpassword"
```

For a persistent setup (user-level):

```
[System.Environment]::SetEnvironmentVariable("OETC_EMAIL", "your@email.com", "User")
[System.Environment]::SetEnvironmentVariable("OETC_PASSWORD", "yourpassword", "User")
```

Verify (restart the terminal first for persistent variables to take effect):

```
echo $env:OETC_EMAIL
```

2.6 Troubleshooting

If the steps below do not resolve your issue, please open a report on the [Support](#) page.

⚠ Out of memory during profile building in `build_renewable_profile`

Building renewable profiles with Atlite is memory-intensive. The default configuration uses 4 parallel processes (~20 GB RAM total). On machines with less than 16 GB, reduce `nprocesses` in `config/config.agora.yaml`:

```
atlite:
  nprocesses: 1 # use 1 on machines with < 16 GB RAM
```

⚠ Limit the number of cores (`--cores`)

By default, `-call ( --cores all )` uses every available CPU core, which can exhaust memory and trigger crashes on Linux. Limiting parallelism reduces peak memory and CPU pressure:

If you run into memory pressure, out-of-memory errors, or system instability during the workflow, rerun the same command with fewer cores. A good first step is to reduce to `--cores 2`, and if needed to `--cores 1`.

```
~/PyPSA-IEI$ snakemake --cores 2 all --configfile config/scenarios/config.SE.yaml
```

⚠ Windows crashes when `solve_sector_networks` starts

On Windows, you can still start the workflow with multiple cores to speed up preprocessing and postprocessing:

```
~/PyPSA-IEI$ snakemake -call all --configfile config/scenarios/config.SE.yaml
```

If the workflow reaches `solve_sector_networks` and then crashes or becomes unstable, rerun the same target with one core:

```
~/PyPSA-IEI$ snakemake --cores 1 all --configfile config/scenarios/config.SE.yaml
```

Snakemake will reuse completed upstream jobs and continue from the remaining solve and postprocessing steps.

2.7 5. Run the Evaluations

To use the analysis scripts developed for this study:

1. Copy the following files into `scripts_analysis/shapes/` :

File	Source (generated by the pipeline)
<code>country_shapes.geojson</code>	<code>resources/<run_name>/country_shapes.geojson</code>
<code>regions_onshore_elec_s_62.geojson</code>	<code>resources/<run_name>/regions_onshore_elec_s_62.geojson</code>
<code>regions_offshore_elec_s_62.geojson</code>	<code>resources/<run_name>/regions_offshore_elec_s_62.geojson</code>

Replace `<run_name>` with the value of `run.name` from your scenario config file (e.g. `2025-MM-DD-branch-2190SEG-SN`). These files are produced by the `build_shapes` and `cluster_network` Snakemake rules and are available after the pipeline has run at least once.

2. Open `scripts_analysis/analysis_main.py` and update the scenario-specific settings so they match the files created by your run:

```
runs = {
    "SE": "2025-MM-DD-branch-2190SEG-SE",
    "CE": "2025-MM-DD-branch-2190SEG-CE",
    # "scenario_3": "run_name_3",
    # "scenario_4": "run_name_4",
}

sector_opts = {
    "SE": "20SEG-T-H-B-I-A",
    "CE": "20SEG-T-H-B-I-A",
    # "scenario_3": "2190SEG-T-H-B-I-A",
    # "scenario_4": "2190SEG-T-H-B-I-A",
}

postnetwork_prefixes = {
    scen: f"elec_s_62_lv99_{sector_opt}"
    for scen, sector_opt in sector_opts.items()
}

# Reference scenario – used as the baseline in all comparison/residual plots.
# Must be one of the keys defined in `runs`.
sel_scen = "SE"

# No need to edit – overridden automatically by the script during execution.
scenarios_for_comp = ["SE", "CE"]

# Every key in `runs` must have an entry here or the script will crash.
scenario_colors = {
    "SE": "#F58220",
    "CE": "#39C1CD",
    # "scenario_3": "#179C7D",
    # "scenario_4": "#854006",
}
```

The run name must match the `run.name` value in the corresponding scenario config file and the folder name under `results/`.

Each `sector_opts` entry must match the solved postnetwork filename suffix exactly, including the temporal resolution and any enabled sector-coupling suffixes. For example:

- full study run: `2190SEG-T-H-B-I-A`
- reduced-resolution sector-coupled test: `20SEG-T-H-B-I-A`

`analysis_main.py` converts these entries into the full postnetwork prefix automatically, so users only need to edit `runs` and `sector_opts`.

Unused scenarios can be commented out.

⚠ At least two entries required in `runs`

The cost analysis script generates comparison plots (residual capital costs, residual operational costs) that require a reference scenario and at least one other scenario to compare against. **Running with only one entry in `runs` will cause a crash.**

If you have only one run, duplicate it under a second key as a workaround:

```
runs = {
    "SE": "2025-MM-DD-branch-2190SEG-SE",
    "SE2": "2025-MM-DD-branch-2190SEG-SE", # same run, avoids crash
}
sector_opts = {
    "SE": "20SEG-T-H-B-I-A",
    "SE2": "20SEG-T-H-B-I-A",
}
sel_scen = "SE"
scenario_colors = {
    "SE": "#39C1CD",
    "SE2": "#39C1CD",
}
```

The residual/comparison plots will show zero differences, which is expected when comparing a scenario against itself.

3. Execute it:

```
python scripts_analysis/analysis_main.py
```

This will run all evaluations automatically.

2.8 Documentation Environment (Optional)

To build or preview this documentation locally, create the lightweight docs environment:

```
conda env create -f envs/environment_docs.yaml
conda activate pypsa-iei-docs
mkdocs serve
```

Then open <http://127.0.0.1:8000> in your browser.

3. Scenario Framework

This page describes the four main scenarios analyzed in the PyPSA-IEI study. Each scenario represents a distinct policy pathway for European energy infrastructure development, defined by two key dimensions:

1. **Infrastructure planning approach:** Cross-sectoral vs. Sectoral silos
 2. **Policy perspective:** European view vs. National view
-

3.1 Policy Dimensions

3.1.1 Dimension 1: Cross-Sectoral vs. Sectoral View

Infrastructure planning can be approached either through **integrated cross-sectoral planning** or through planning in **sectoral silos**.

Cross-Sectoral View

Infrastructure planning considers the interaction between sectors (electricity, natural gas, hydrogen) in a consistent, harmonised way. This enables:

- Integrated, cost-optimal grid expansion across all energy carriers
- Efficient sector-coupling approaches
- Minimization of system-wide costs
- Avoidance of grid bottlenecks and overcapacities

Implementation Details

The existing grid and already advanced TYNDP projects (i.e., with status "in construction" for electricity, "FID" for gas) form the lower boundary for endogenous transmission capacity expansions. The optimization model can freely expand transmission capacities for electricity, gas, hydrogen, and CO₂ networks beyond these baseline projects.

For detailed project lists, see Annex 2 in the [published report](#).

Sectoral View (Silos)

Infrastructure planning treats energy networks largely independently, with electricity, natural gas, and hydrogen networks planned separately. This reflects current practices like the TYNDP process, but involves risks:

- Unnecessarily high energy system costs
- Potential grid bottlenecks
- Overcapacities in technologies and infrastructure
- Lack of coordination between energy carriers

Implementation Details

The existing grid and all sectoral infrastructure projects (TYNDP, H2 Infrastructure Map, and German Hydrogen Core Network) are the only capacity expansions permitted in the system **until 2040**. This reflects network capacity expansion as envisioned by grid planners. After 2040, the optimization model can freely expand transmission capacities.

For electricity networks, this includes less advanced TYNDP projects with maturity status "in permitting" and "under consideration". For complete project listings, see Annex 2 in the [published report](#).

3.1.2 Dimension 2: European vs. National View

The second dimension reflects the tension between European internal market integration and national protectionist tendencies.

European View

The European internal market paradigm supports free trade and optimal resource allocation across borders. The model:

- Can freely optimize the share of imported versus domestically generated electricity and hydrogen
- Maximizes system-wide efficiency
- Leverages regional comparative advantages
- No self-sufficiency constraints are activated

Implementation Details

Self-sufficiency constraints are **not activated**. The system freely optimizes imports and exports on both hourly and annual basis to minimize total system costs.

National View

National perspectives prioritize minimizing energy import dependencies (even from within the EU) by expanding domestic generation and storage capacities. Motivations include:

- Energy security concerns
- Keeping domestic electricity prices low
- Avoiding political dependencies
- National self-determination

This approach can lead to:

- Unnecessarily high system costs
- Excess regional capacities despite sub-optimal generation conditions
- Underutilization of low-cost generation potentials in other countries

Implementation Details

Self-sufficiency constraints are **activated** to require high shares of domestic generation for each country. These constraints operate on an **annual basis** (hourly imports/exports remain unrestricted).

For detailed constraint formulation, see [Self-Sufficiency Constraints](#) or Annex 1 in the [published report](#).

Parameterization:

Year	Electricity Min. National Generation	Hydrogen Min. National Generation	Export Capacity Buffer
2030	80%	70%	+10% of demand
2050	100%	70%	+10% of demand

- Electricity self-sufficiency increases linearly from 80% (2030) to 100% (2050)
- Hydrogen self-sufficiency remains constant at 70%
- Countries must build sufficient capacity to export 10% of their electricity/hydrogen demand

3.2 The Four Main Scenarios

	European View (no self-sufficiency constraints)	National View (with self-sufficiency constraints)
Cross-Sectoral (free grid expansion)	CE <i>Cross-sectoral, European</i> Cost-optimal integrated planning	CN <i>Cross-sectoral, National</i> Integrated planning with self-sufficiency
Sectoral (fixed grid expansion until 2040)	SE <i>Sectoral, European</i> Sectoral planning with free trade	SN <i>Sectoral, National</i> Sectoral planning with self-sufficiency

3.3 Detailed Scenario Descriptions

3.3.1 CE Scenario (Cross-sectoral, European view)

Configuration file: `config/scenarios/config.CE.yaml`

The **CE scenario** represents fully integrated, cost-optimal European energy infrastructure planning. This scenario serves as the **cost-optimal benchmark** against which other scenarios are compared.

View

Characteristics

- ✔ **Free transmission expansion** for all sectors (electricity, gas, hydrogen, CO₂)
- ✔ **No self-sufficiency constraints**
- ✔ Existing grid + advanced TYNDP projects form the lower bound
- ✔ Free optimization of import vs. domestic generation shares

View

Expected Outcomes

- Cost-optimal generation, storage, and sectorally-integrated grid expansion
- Maximum utilization of regional comparative advantages
- Lowest system-wide costs
- High cross-border energy flows where economically efficient
- Achievement of climate neutrality by 2050 at minimal cost

3.3.2 CN Scenario (Cross-sectoral, National view)

Configuration file: `config/scenarios/config.CN.yaml`

The **CN scenario** combines integrated infrastructure planning with national self-sufficiency objectives. This scenario explores the **cost of energy sovereignty** within an otherwise optimally integrated system.

View Characteristics

-  **Free transmission expansion** for all sectors (electricity, gas, hydrogen, CO₂)
-  **Self-sufficiency constraints activated**
-  Existing grid + advanced TYNDP projects form the lower bound
-  High share of domestic generation required (80-100% electricity, 70% hydrogen)

View Expected Outcomes

- Sectorally-integrated grid expansion within national constraints
- High level of national energy supply
- Low import dependence (including intra-European)
- Higher domestic generation and storage capacities
- Increased system costs compared to CE due to sub-optimal resource allocation
- Underutilization of cross-border transmission despite available capacity

3.3.3 SE Scenario (Sectoral, European view)

Configuration file: `config/scenarios/config.SE.yaml`

The **SE scenario** reflects current infrastructure planning practices (e.g., TYNDP) with European market integration. This scenario evaluates the **cost of sectoral planning** under current institutional frameworks.

View Characteristics

-  **Fixed transmission expansion until 2040** based on:
 - TYNDP electricity projects (including "in permitting" and "under consideration")
 - TYNDP gas projects
 - H2 Infrastructure Map
 - German Hydrogen Core Network
-  **No self-sufficiency constraints**
-  Free optimization of import vs. domestic generation shares
-  Free transmission expansion after 2040

View Expected Outcomes

- Good EU-wide coordination on trade and generation
- Sub-optimal infrastructure due to sectoral planning silos
- Networks may be insufficient or misaligned for integrated sector-coupling
- Potential grid bottlenecks or stranded assets
- Higher costs than CE due to lack of integrated infrastructure optimization
- Increased reliance on generation and storage to compensate for grid constraints

3.3.4 SN Scenario (Sectoral, National view)

Configuration file: `config/scenarios/config.SN.yaml`

The **SN scenario** represents the most constrained policy pathway, combining sectoral planning with national protectionism. This scenario represents the **worst-case policy pathway** where both infrastructure planning and trade policies work against system optimization.

View Characteristics

- ⚠️ **Fixed transmission expansion until 2040** (same as SE)
- ⚠️ **Self-sufficiency constraints activated**
- ⚠️ High share of domestic generation required (80-100% electricity, 70% hydrogen)
- ⚠️ Limited cross-border coordination
- ✅ Free transmission expansion after 2040

View Expected Outcomes

- Uncoordinated expansion of generation and grid infrastructure
- Highest system costs among all scenarios
- Significant overcapacities in some regions, bottlenecks in others
- Sub-optimal use of renewable resources
- Stranded assets due to fixed, uncoordinated network planning
- Low cross-border energy flows despite physical interconnection

3.4 Sensitivity Scenarios

In addition to the four main scenarios, several **sensitivity analyses** were conducted based on the CE scenario to test robustness:

Scenario	Configuration File	Description
CE (base)	<code>config.CE.yaml</code>	Reference scenario
CE - No Gas/Oil	<code>config.CE_no_gas_no_oil.yaml</code>	Fossil gas and oil phase-out
CE - Flexibility	<code>config.CE_flexibility.yaml</code>	Limited flexibility options
CE - Expensive Compensation	<code>config.CE_expensive_compensation.yaml</code>	Higher balancing costs
CE - TransHyDE S2	<code>config.CE_TranshydeS2.yaml</code>	Alternative industrial demand profile

3.5 Running Scenarios

To execute a specific scenario, use Snakemake with the corresponding configuration file:

```
snakemake -call all --configfile config/scenarios/config.CE.yaml
```

Replace `config.CE.yaml` with the desired scenario configuration file.

For detailed execution instructions, see the [Installation](#) page.

3.6 Key Differences Summary

Feature	CE	CN	SE	SN
Grid expansion (until 2040)	Free	Free	Fixed (TYNDP)	Fixed (TYNDP)
Grid expansion (after 2040)	Free	Free	Free	Free
Self-sufficiency constraints	 No	 Yes	 No	 Yes
Cross-border optimization	Full	Limited	Full	Limited
Expected system cost	Lowest	Medium-low	Medium-high	Highest
Infrastructure planning	Integrated	Integrated	Sectoral silos	Sectoral silos
Trade policy	European market	National focus	European market	National focus

3.7 Related Documentation

- [Self-Sufficiency Constraints](#) — Technical implementation details
- [TYNDP Electricity Projects](#) — Fixed electricity network projects
- [Gas Networks](#) — TYNDP gas pipeline implementation
- [Hydrogen Networks](#) — H2 Infrastructure Map and Core Network
- [Expansion Limits](#) — Constraints on capacity expansion

3.8 References

For comprehensive methodology and results analysis, please refer to:

"Integrated Infrastructure Planning and 2050 Climate Neutrality: Deriving Future-Proof European Energy Infrastructures" Fraunhofer IEG, Fraunhofer ISI, and d-fine (November 2025) [Download report \(PDF\)](#)

4. Model Functionality

4.1 Model Functionality Overview

This section describes the key extensions and modifications made to the [PyPSA-Eur v0.10.0](#) base model for the PyPSA-IEI study. Each sub-page covers one topic with a description, the relevant Snakemake rule(s), and code/config snippets for reproducibility and future modification.

4.1.1 Contents

Topic	Description
Costs	Custom cost assumptions from config and technology-data
Lifetimes	Country- and plant-level powerplant lifetime adjustments
Gas	TYNDP gas pipelines, Russian import removal
Hydrogen	Wasserstoffkernnetz, ENTSO-G network, retrofitting
CO₂ Pipeline Network	Spatial CO ₂ tracking, bidirectional pipeline links, sequestration caps
Industrial Demand	TransHyDe-based industrial energy demand
Imports	H ₂ , syngas, and synfuel import nodes
Losses	Transmission efficiency and compression losses
TYNDP Electricity Projects	Cross-border TYNDP transmission enforcement
National Grid Plans	National transmission expansion factors per country
Myopic Optimization	Brownfield capacity accounting across horizons
Expansion Limits	Min/max capacity constraints per carrier and country
Self-Sufficiency Constraints	Minimum/maximum self-sufficiency targets per region
Overall Minimum Capacities	System-wide minimum capacity per carrier
Capacity Reserve Margin	Reserve margin above peak demand for conventional generation
Import Infrastructure Retrofitting	Gas import infrastructure reuse for H ₂ and syngas
Curtailment Mode	Explicit renewable curtailment modeling

4.2 Parameters & Configuration

4.2.1 Costs

Overview

The model uses cost assumptions from [technology-data v0.9.0](#) as a baseline (stored in `data/costs_{planning_horizon}.csv`). Selected investment costs are **overridden per planning horizon** using values defined in `config/config.agora.yaml`.

Snakemake Rule

Rule: `update_costs_csv`

Script: `scripts/update_costs_csv.py`

This rule reads the baseline costs CSV and updates specific technology investment costs before the network is built.

How It Works

`scripts/update_costs_csv.py`

```
def insert_new_costs(costs_file, invest_update, filename):
    costs = pd.read_csv(costs_file).set_index('technology')
    for key, investment in invest_update.items():
        mask = (costs.parameter == "investment") & (costs.index == key)
        costs.loc[mask, 'value'] = investment
    costs.to_csv(filename)

# Called with per-horizon values from config:
investment_update = snakemake.params.invest_update[int(snakemake.wildcards.planning_horizons)]
insert_new_costs(snakemake.input.costs, investment_update, snakemake.output.costs)
```

Technologies Updated in All Scenarios

These investment costs are overridden for **every scenario** and every planning year:

Technology	Config key
HVDC overhead line	HVDC overhead
HVDC submarine cable	HVDC submarine
HVAC overhead line	HVAC overhead
H ₂ electrolysis	electrolysis
CO ₂ pipeline	CO2 pipeline
CO ₂ submarine pipeline	CO2 submarine pipeline

Additional Technologies (CE Flexibility Scenario Only)

In the CE flexibility scenario (`config.CE_flexibility.yaml`), investment costs for the following heat-sector technologies are set to **20% above the technology-data v0.9.0 baseline** for every planning year:

Technology (config key)
central air-sourced heat pump
central ground-sourced heat pump
decentral air-sourced heat pump
decentral ground-sourced heat pump
central solid biomass CHP
central gas CHP
micro CHP
biomass CHP capture
central water tank storage
decentral water tank storage
central resistive heater
decentral resistive heater

Example for 2030:

Technology	Unit	Baseline (tech-data)	CE Flexibility (+20%)
central air-sourced heat pump	EUR/kW_th	906.1	1087.3
decentral air-sourced heat pump	EUR/kW_th	899.5	1079.4
central gas CHP	EUR/kW	592.6	711.1
micro CHP	EUR/kW_th	7841.7	9410.1
central water tank storage	EUR/kWh	0.576	0.691

How to Modify the Cost Parameters

STEP 1: FIND THE CORRECT TECHNOLOGY NAME

Technology names must exactly match the `technology` column in `data/costs_<year>.csv`, which in turn comes from [technology-data v0.9.0](#).

STEP 2: EDIT THE SCENARIO CONFIG FILE

Add or update the technology under `costs.investment` in `config/config.agora.yaml` (base config, applies to all scenarios) or in a scenario-specific file to override only for that scenario. Units depend on the technology — check the `unit` column in the costs CSV first.

config/config.agora.yaml or config/scenarios/config/*.yaml

```
costs:
  investment:
    2020:
      HVDC overhead: 2000.0      # EUR/MW/km – IEA 2023
      HVDC submarine: 2000.0    # EUR/MW/km
      HVAC overhead: 500.0      # EUR/MW/km
      electrolysis: 1260.0       # EUR/kW_e – IEA Global Hydrogen Review 2023
      CO2 pipeline: 13000.0      # EUR/(tCO2/h)/km – Danish Energy Agency
      CO2 submarine pipeline: 33000.0 # EUR/(tCO2/h)/km – Danish Energy Agency
    2025:
      HVDC overhead: 2000.0
      ...
```

4.2.2 Powerplant Lifetimes

Overview

Standard `powerplantmatching` data does not always reflect country-specific or plant-specific decommissioning decisions. This model updates powerplant lifetimes based on a custom CSV, incorporating data from:

- [Beyond Fossil Fuels](#)
- Reuters
- [Forum Energii](#) (2024)

Snakemake Rule

Rule: `build_powerplants`

Script: `scripts/build_powerplants.py`

Data file: `data/powerplant_lifetime.csv`

How It Works

The `build_powerplants` rule retrieves the standard powerplant database from [powerplantmatching](#) and then calls `manipulate_lifetimes()` to apply corrections from the custom CSV:

`scripts/build_powerplants.py`

```
ppl = manipulate_lifetimes(ppl, snakemake.input.new_ppl_lifetimes)
```

The function handles four cases based on the `Name` and `status` columns:

`scripts/build_powerplants.py`

```
def manipulate_lifetimes(ppl_lifetime, path_lifetimes):
    lifetime_data = pd.read_csv(path_lifetimes)

    # Four adjustment categories:
    ppl_specific_lifetimes_limit = lifetime_data.query("(Name!='all') & (status=='limit')")
    country_level_lifetimes_limit = lifetime_data.query("(Name=='all') & (status=='limit')")
    ppl_specific_lifetimes_ext = lifetime_data.query("(Name!='all') & (status=='extend')")
    country_level_lifetimes_ext = lifetime_data.query("(Name=='all') & (status=='extend')")

    # For 'limit': replace DateOut only if the new date is *earlier* than the existing one
    # For 'extend': replace DateOut only if the new date is *later* than the existing one
    # Applied first at country level, then at individual plant level
```

Adjustments are applied at two levels:

- **Country-level** (`Name == 'all'`): All plants of a given fuel type in a country get their `DateOut` updated (e.g. coal phase-out in Germany by 2030)
- **Plant-level** (`Name != 'all'`): Individual plants receive specific retirement years based on confirmed announcements

The logic is conservative: a `limit` entry only takes effect if the plant would have lived *longer* than specified; an `extend` entry only takes effect if the plant would have retired *earlier* than specified.

Data Format

`data/powerplant_lifetime.csv` columns (in order):

Column	Description
Country	ISO2 country code
Fueltype	e.g. Lignite, Hard Coal, Nuclear
DateOut	Target retirement year
Name	Plant name for plant-level rules; all for country-level rules
status	limit (force earlier retirement) or extend (force later retirement)
Reference	Data source citation

Current Data in `powerplant_lifetime.csv`**COAL / LIGNITE PHASE-OUTS (COUNTRY-LEVEL `limit`)**

All entries use `Name = all` and `status = limit`, sourced from [Beyond Fossil Fuels](#) except Poland which uses Forum Energii (25.11.2024):

Country	Fueltype	DateOut
PL	Lignite + Hard Coal	2044
DE	Lignite + Hard Coal	2038
BG	Lignite + Hard Coal	2038
HR, CZ, SI	Lignite + Hard Coal	2033
ME	Lignite + Hard Coal	2035
RO	Lignite + Hard Coal	2032
MK	Lignite + Hard Coal	2030
NL, FI	Lignite + Hard Coal	2029
DK	Lignite + Hard Coal	2028
FR, HU, IT	Lignite + Hard Coal	2027
GR	Lignite + Hard Coal	2026
ES, IE	Lignite + Hard Coal	2025
SK	Lignite + Hard Coal	2024
GB	Lignite + Hard Coal	2024
PT	Lignite + Hard Coal	2021
AT, SE	Lignite + Hard Coal	2020
BE	Lignite + Hard Coal	2016

NUCLEAR LIFETIME EXTENSIONS (PLANT-LEVEL `extend`)

French plants extended per Macron's 2022 announcement (Reuters), Belgian reactors extended per the 2023 Engie agreement (Reuters):

Country	Plant	DateOut
FR	Civaux	2057
FR	Nogent, Belleville	2047
FR	Golfech, Penly	2050
FR	St Alban, Flamanville	2045
FR	Cruas	2043
FR	Paluel	2044
FR	Cattenom	2038
FR	Blayais, Gravelines, Dampierre	2040-2041
FR	Chooz	2027
FR	Bugey	2032
FR	Chinon	2023
BE	Doel, Tihange	2035

How to Modify

The active lifetime file is set in the config under `electricity`:

config/config.agora.yaml

```
electricity:
  new_powerplant_lifetimes: data/powerplant_lifetime.csv
```

You have two options depending on whether the change should apply to **all runs** or only to **specific scenarios**.

OPTION 1: EDIT THE SHARED FILE (APPLIES TO ALL RUNS)

Edit `data/powerplant_lifetime.csv` directly. All runs that reference this file will pick up the change.

Limit a country-wide fuel type (phase-out)

Set `Name` to `all` and `status` to `limit`. All plants of that fuel type in that country will retire no later than `DateOut`:

```
Country,Fueltype,DateOut,Name,status,Reference
DE,Lignite,2030,all,limit,custom
PL,Hard Coal,2040,all,limit,custom
```

Extend a country-wide fuel type (lifetime extension)

```
Country,Fueltype,DateOut,Name,status,Reference
CZ,Nuclear,2050,all,extend,custom
```

Override a specific plant

Use the exact plant name as it appears in the powerplantmatching database:

```
Country,Fueltype,DateOut,Name,status,Reference
PL,Lignite,2036,Bełchatów,limit,custom
CZ,Nuclear,2050,Dukovany,extend,custom
```

OPTION 2: CREATE A SCENARIO-SPECIFIC FILE (APPLIES TO SELECTED RUNS ONLY)

1. Copy the base file and give it a descriptive name:

```
cp data/powerplant_lifetime.csv data/powerplant_lifetime_nuclear_extension.csv
```

2. Edit the copy with the scenario-specific adjustments.
3. Point to it in the relevant scenario config under `config/scenarios/`:

config/scenarios/config.MY_SCENARIO.yaml

```
electricity:
  new_powerplant_lifetimes: data/powerplant_lifetime_nuclear_extension.csv
```

This overrides only `new_powerplant_lifetimes` for that scenario; all other config values remain inherited from `config.agora.yaml`.

Tip

This approach is recommended when you want to compare scenarios with different phase-out assumptions — e.g. a baseline with the default file and a sensitivity with a more aggressive coal exit date — without touching the shared file.

4.2.3 Transmission Losses

Overview

Transmission losses are modelled by splitting each bidirectional link into two unidirectional links with `efficiency < 1.0`. The function `lossy_bidirectional_links()` is applied to every carrier listed under `sector.transmission_efficiency` in the config. DC links carry a static converter loss and a length-dependent resistive loss. H₂ and gas pipelines carry compression losses, drawn as electricity from the sending node. TYNDP gas pipelines receive the same loss parameters as standard gas pipelines.

Snakemake Rule

Rule: `prepare_sector_network`

Script: `scripts/prepare_sector_network.py` — function `lossy_bidirectional_links()`

Carriers with Losses

Carrier	<code>efficiency_static</code>	<code>efficiency_per_1000km</code>	<code>compression_per_1000km</code>
DC	0.98	0.977	—
H ₂ pipeline	—	1.0	0.019
gas pipeline	—	1.0	0.010
electricity distribution grid	1.0	—	—

Implementation

Each bidirectional link is split into a forward link (efficiency applied by length and static factor) and a reversed copy (`capital_cost = 0`, `length = 0`). For H₂ and gas pipelines, a secondary electricity bus (`bus2`) is attached at the sending node and `efficiency2` is set to a negative value proportional to pipeline length, representing compression energy consumption.

The function is called in a loop over all configured carriers:

scripts/prepare_sector_network.py

```
for k, v in options["transmission_efficiency"].items():
    lossy_bidirectional_links(n, k, v)
```

TYNDP gas pipelines receive an additional dedicated call using the same `gas pipeline` efficiencies:

scripts/prepare_sector_network.py

```
losses = snakemake.config["sector"]["transmission_efficiency"]["gas pipeline"]
lossy_bidirectional_links(n, "gas pipeline tyndp", losses)
```

Configuration

Efficiency parameters are set under `sector.transmission_efficiency`:

config/config.agora.yaml

```
sector:
  transmission_efficiency:
    DC:
      efficiency_static: 0.98
      efficiency_per_1000km: 0.977
    H2 pipeline:
      efficiency_per_1000km: 1      # 0.979 commented out
      compression_per_1000km: 0.019
    gas pipeline:
      efficiency_per_1000km: 1      # 0.977 commented out
      compression_per_1000km: 0.01
    electricity distribution grid:
      efficiency_static: 1          # 0.97 commented out
```

Note

`solving.options.transmission_losses` does **not** control whether losses are applied. It only triggers removal of AC lines with `num_parallel == 0` that would conflict with the loss-aware solver:

```
solving:
  options:
    transmission_losses: 2
```

How to Change Transmission Loss Values

Edit the efficiency values under `sector.transmission_efficiency` in `config/config.agora.yaml` or a scenario override file. Setting `efficiency_per_1000km: 1` and `compression_per_1000km: 0` for a carrier effectively disables losses for that carrier.

4.2.4 Flexible Time Segmentation

Overview

Full-year hourly time series (8760 snapshots) make sector-coupled optimisation extremely slow. To keep solve times tractable, the model aggregates snapshots into a smaller number of **representative segments** using the `tsam` library. The number of segments is controlled via the `sector_opts` wildcard (e.g. `2190SEG`, `20SEG`) and can be changed freely for each run without touching any script.

Two simpler alternatives also exist:

Method	<code>sector_opts</code> example	Effect
Temporal segmentation (tsam)	<code>2190SEG</code>	Aggregate 8760 h → N representative segments
Hourly resampling	<code>4h</code>	Average every 4 hours → 2190 snapshots
No aggregation	<i>(no suffix)</i>	Keep all hourly snapshots

Snakemake Rules

Rule: `time_aggregation` (in `rules/build_sector.smk`)

Script: `scripts/time_aggregation.py`

This rule runs **before** `prepare_sector_network` and writes a CSV of snapshot weightings. The sector-coupled network then reads that CSV and applies the aggregation.

Rule: `prepare_sector_network`

Script: `scripts/prepare_sector_network.py` — function `set_temporal_aggregation()`

How It Works

STEP 1 — COMPUTE SNAPSHOT WEIGHTINGS (`time_aggregation.py`)

All time-varying data is collected (generator profiles, load, heat demand, solar thermal) and normalised to the unit interval. `tsam` then partitions the 8760-hour year into N contiguous segments, each described by a representative hour and a duration weight:

`scripts/time_aggregation.py`

```
agg = tsam.TimeSeriesAggregation(
    df,
    hoursPerPeriod=len(df), # treat the whole year as one period
    noTypicalPeriods=1,
    noSegments=segments,    # e.g. 2190 or 20
    segmentation=True,
    solver=snakemake.params.solver_name,
)
```

```
agg = agg.createTypicalPeriods()

weightings = agg.index.get_level_values("Segment Duration")
offsets = np.insert(np.cumsum(weightings[:-1]), 0, 0)
snapshot_weightings = n.snapshot_weightings.loc[n.snapshots[offsets]].mul(
    weightings, axis=0
)
snapshot_weightings.to_csv(snakemake.output.snapshot_weightings)
```

The result is a CSV with one row per segment, indexed by the representative timestamp and holding the duration of that segment in hours.

STEP 2 — APPLY TO THE SECTOR-COUPLED NETWORK (`prepare_sector_network.py`)

`set_temporal_aggregation()` reads the CSV and reindexes all time-dependent network data (profiles, loads, snapshot weightings) to the reduced set of snapshots:

scripts/prepare_sector_network.py

```
snapshot_weightings = pd.read_csv(
    snakemake.input.snapshot_weightings, index_col=0, parse_dates=True
)
set_temporal_aggregation(n, snapshot_weightings)
```

Configuration

VIA THE `sector_opts` WILDCARD

The number of segments is set in `sector_opts` in the scenario config file. The `SEG` suffix is parsed at runtime — no code change is needed:

config/scenarios/config.SE.yaml

```
scenario:
  sector_opts:
    - 2190SEG-T-H-B-I-A # full study resolution
```

sector_opts	value	Segments	Intended use
2190SEG-T-H-B-I-A		2190	Full study (publication results)
20SEG-T-H-B-I-A		20	Pipeline test with sector coupling
20SEG		20	Electricity-only pipeline test

VIA THE STATIC CONFIG (ALTERNATIVE)

`snapshots.segmentation` in `config/config.agora.yaml` can also trigger segmentation. It is `false` by default — all scenarios use the wildcard approach instead:

config/config.agora.yaml

```
snapshots:
  start: "2013-01-01"
  end: "2014-01-01"
  inclusive: 'left'
```

```
resolution: false    # hourly resampling, e.g. "4h" – disabled by default
segmentation: false  # static segment count – disabled by default
```

The wildcard always takes precedence over the static config value.

How to Change the Number of Segments

Edit `sector_opts` in the relevant scenario config:

config/scenarios/config.SE.yaml

```
scenario:
  sector_opts:
    - 20SEG-T-H-B-I-A  # fewer segments → faster, less accurate
```

Warning

Results produced with different segment counts are **not directly comparable**. The study uses 2190SEG for all published results. Use reduced counts (e.g. 20SEG) only for pipeline testing.

4.3 Network Infrastructure

4.3.1 Gas Network

Overview

The gas network is a **standard PyPSA-Eur feature**. The existing European transmission infrastructure is reconstructed from two open datasets and added to the model as PyPSA `Link` components. This page describes how that base infrastructure is represented, followed by the two modifications made in this project relative to base PyPSA-Eur:

1. **Russian gas imports are removed** in all scenarios by default
2. **TYNDP gas pipeline projects** are processed and added to the model

Existing Infrastructure (PyPSA-Eur)

DATA SOURCES

Dataset	What it provides
SciGRID_gas (scigrid.de)	European pipe geometry, diameter, pressure, bidirectionality, underground storage locations
GEM (Global Energy Monitor)	LNG terminal locations and capacities, onshore production sites

BUILD PIPELINE

Three Snakemake rules prepare the existing network before it reaches `prepare_sector_network`:

1. `build_gas_network` (`scripts/build_gas_network.py`) — loads the SciGRID_gas GeoJSON (`IGGIELGN_PipeSegments.geojson`); infers pipe capacity from diameter using the piecewise-linear formula from the [European Hydrogen Backbone report](#) (e.g. 500 mm → ~1.5 GW, 900 mm → ~11.25 GW); corrects outlier capacities and lengths; flags short pipes (<10 km) as bidirectional.
2. `cluster_gas_network` (`scripts/cluster_gas_network.py`) — spatially joins both pipe endpoints to model bus regions; recalculates length as $\text{haversine} \times 1.25$ (routing factor); drops intra-region pipes; aggregates parallel pipes on the same corridor by summing `p_nom`.
3. `build_gas_input_locations` (`scripts/build_gas_input_locations.py`) — assembles per-node supply capacity tables for LNG terminals, cross-border pipeline entry points, onshore production, and underground storage.

When `H2_retrofit: true`, gas pipes become candidates for conversion to hydrogen transport — their capital cost is reduced to a small decommissioning penalty and capacity is freed for `"H2 pipeline retrofitted"` links on the same corridors.

Russian Import Removal

Rule: `build_gas_input_locations` **Script:** `scripts/build_gas_input_locations.py`

The base config sets `import_from_russia: false` under `sector:`, so Russian pipeline entry points are excluded in all scenarios. If re-enabled but `nordstream` is disabled, only the Nord Stream pipeline is excluded:

`scripts/build_gas_input_locations.py`

```
if not snakemake.params.import_from_russia:
    entry = entry.loc[~(entry.from_country == "RU")]
elif not snakemake.params.nordstream:
    entry = entry.loc[entry.id != "INET_BP_63"]
```

TYNDP Gas Pipelines

Rule: `build_tyndp_gas_pipes`

Script: `scripts/build_tyndp_gas_pipes.py`

Input file: `data/gas_network/TYNDP_Gas_Interconnectors.xlsx`

INPUT DATA FORMAT

The Excel file contains the following columns (rows with any missing value in these columns are dropped):

Column	Type	Description
Code	string	Unique project identifier (e.g. TRA-N-7)
Project Name	string	Human-readable project name; combined with Code into a tag field
Maturity Status	string	One of FID, Advanced, Less-Advanced — used for scenario-dependent filtering
Diameter (mm)	float	Pipe inner diameter; converted to capacity via the same piecewise-linear formula used for existing SciGRID_gas pipes
Length (km)	float	Pipeline length in km
PCI 5th List	string	Yes or No — whether the project is on the EU Projects of Common Interest (PCI) 5th list
Project Commissioning Year Last	int	Latest commissioning year; determines which planning horizon the pipe is built in
Start	string	Start location — either a 2-letter country code (e.g. DE) for countries with a single cluster, or DMS coordinates (e.g. 51°30'N 000°07'E) for countries with multiple clusters
End	string	End location — same format as Start

Additional columns present in the file (Project Description, Capacities, Reference) are read but dropped before output.

Adding a new project

Copy an existing row, assign a new Code, fill in all required columns, and set Maturity Status to the appropriate level. The script will automatically:

- convert Diameter (mm) to MW capacity
- resolve 2-letter country codes or DMS coordinates to model cluster names
- drop the project if both endpoints fall within the same cluster

TYNDP gas pipeline project data is processed and mapped to model cluster regions using geographic coordinates:

scripts/build_tyndp_gas_pipes.py

```
# Load TYNDP project list
tyndp_raw_data = pd.read_excel(snakemake.input.tyndp_gas_projects)

# Remove projects with missing critical data
tyndp_raw_data.dropna(subset=[
```

```

'Code', 'Project Name', 'Maturity Status', 'Diameter (mm)',
'Length (km)', 'PCI 5th List', 'Project Commissioning Year Last',
'Start', 'End'
], inplace=True)

# Convert DMS coordinates to cluster names
def coordinates_to_cluster(coordinates):
    ...
    point = Point(dd_lon, dd_lat)
    return regions.loc[regions['geometry'].contains(point), 'name'].values[0]

```

Pipe capacity is derived from diameter using the `diameter_to_capacity` function (from `build_gas_network.py`). Projects entirely within one cluster are dropped. The output is saved to CSV for use in `prepare_sector_network`.

SCENARIO-DEPENDENT PROJECT SELECTION

TYNDP projects are filtered by maturity status via the scenario config:

Scenario	allowed_statuses
CE, CN	FID only
SE, SN	FID, Advanced, Less-Advanced (default — no override in scenario config)

config/scenarios/config.CE.yaml

```

policy_plans:
  include_tyndp_gas:
    enable: true
    allowed_statuses:
      - FID # Final Investment Decision

```

Pipeline Extendability

```

graph TD
  A[SciGRID_gas] -->| "build_gas_network\ncluster_gas_network" | B["gas pipeline\n- existing -"]
  B -->| "H2_retrofit: true\nnp_nom_max = p_nom" | C["H2 pipeline retrofitted\nnp_nom_max ≤ 0.6 × gas p_nom"]

  D["k-edge augmentation\ngas_network_connectivity_upgrade"] --> E["gas pipeline new\n- connectivity gaps -"]

  F[(TYNDP Excel)] -->| "build_tyndp_gas_pipes" | G["gas pipeline tyndp\nnp_nom_extendable=False"]

  style B fill:#BDD7EE,color:#1a1a1a
  style C fill:#D9B3F0,color:#1a1a1a
  style E fill:#C6E0B4,color:#1a1a1a
  style G fill:#FCE4D6,color:#1a1a1a

```

i PyPSA capacity parameters

- `p_nom` — the nominal (installed) capacity of a link in MW. For existing pipes this equals the current physical capacity read from the dataset.
- `p_nom_extendable` — if `True`, the optimizer may change the capacity; if `False`, the capacity is fixed at `p_nom` and no investment decision is made.
- `p_nom_min` / `p_nom_max` — bounds on the capacity the optimizer can choose. `p_nom_max = p_nom` means the pipe can never grow beyond its current size; `p_nom_min = 0` means it can shrink all the way to zero (i.e. be decommissioned).

Type	Carrier	Source	<code>p_nom_extendable</code>
Existing pipes	<code>gas pipeline</code>	SciGRID_gas (clustered)	Depends on <code>H2_retrofit</code> and <code>wasserstoff_kernnetz.optimize_after</code> — see below
New connectivity pipes	<code>gas pipeline new</code>	k-edge augmentation	Always <code>True</code> — controlled by <code>include_tyndp_gas.optimize_after</code>
TYNDP projects	<code>gas pipeline tyndp</code>	TYNDP Excel file	Always <code>False</code> — fixed at commissioned capacity

EXISTING PIPES (`gas pipeline`)

Behaviour depends on whether `H2_retrofit` is enabled:

- **`H2_retrofit: true`** (default): Existing pipes get a small decommissioning capital cost (`0.1 €/MW/km/a`), `p_nom_max = p_nom` and `p_nom_min = 0`. The pipe capacity is therefore **capped at its current value** — it can never grow. Instead the optimizer can *reduce* it toward zero, freeing that capacity for `H2 pipeline` retrofitted links on the same corridors. Two separate mechanisms reduce gas pipe capacity:
 - Exogenous reduction** (`scripts/modify_prenetwork.py`): when `wasserstoff_kernnetz` is enabled, gas pipe `p_nom` is directly reduced by the `removed_gas_cap` of all Wasserstoffkernnetz (hydrogen core network) pipes commissioned up to the current horizon — this happens unconditionally, before any optimization.
 - Optimizer reduction** (`scripts/prepare_sector_network.py`): whether the optimizer can *additionally* reduce gas capacity is controlled by `wasserstoff_kernnetz.optimize_after` via `p_nom_extendable` — fixed until that year, freely reducible after. The same `optimize_after` parameter also gates all **H2 pipeline** extendability (carriers containing `"H2 pipeline"`) in `scripts/modify_prenetwork.py`.
- **`H2_retrofit: false`**: Pipes are fully extendable with no upper bound (`p_nom_max = inf`, `p_nom_min = p_nom`, full capital cost charged) — capacity can grow freely.

NEW CONNECTIVITY PIPES (`gas pipeline new`)

Added via k-edge augmentation to ensure `gas_network_connectivity_upgrade`-connectivity of the gas bus graph. Always extendable. Whether they are added at all is controlled by `include_tyndp_gas.optimize_after`: set to `false` to suppress them entirely, `true` (default) to always add

them. An integer value has no practical gating effect due to how the logic is implemented — only `false` prevents new pipes from being added.

TYNDP GAS PROJECTS (`gas pipeline tyndp`)

Commissioned at fixed capacity (`p_nom_extendable=False`) in the planning horizon their commissioning year falls into. The `optimize_after` key in the config has **no effect** on these — it controls new connectivity pipes only.

No `optimize_after` for gas

Unlike TYNDP electricity projects and national grid plans, TYNDP gas pipelines are always added as **fixed capacity** (`p_nom_extendable=False`). The `optimize_after` key exists in the config but has no effect — commissioned projects are simply built in the horizon they fall into and cannot be further optimized.

How to Modify the Gas Network

CHANGE WHICH TYNDP PROJECTS ARE INCLUDED

Set `allowed_statuses` in the scenario config file. To allow all maturity levels, omit the key entirely:

config/scenarios/config.CE.yaml

```
policy_plans:
  include_tyndp_gas:
    enable: true
    allowed_statuses:
      - FID
      - Advanced
      - Less Advanced
```

CONTROL RUSSIAN IMPORT HANDLING

Override the parameter in the scenario config:

```
sector:
  import_from_russia: false # set to true to allow Russian pipeline gas
  nordstream: false       # set to true to include Nord Stream specifically
```

To add custom gas pipeline projects, extend the TYNDP Excel input file (`data/gas_network/TYNDP_Gas_Interconnectors.xlsx`) — see the [Input data format](#) table above for the required columns.

4.3.2 Hydrogen Network

Overview

H₂ pipelines are present in **all scenarios**, but the treatment differs:

Feature	CE / CN	SE / SN
Retrofit of existing gas pipes to H ₂	✓ endogenous	✓ endogenous
New-build H ₂ pipelines	✓ endogenous from 2020	✓ endogenous from 2020
<i>Wasserstoffkernnetz</i> + European H ₂ infrastructure map	✗	✓ pre-committed until 2040

In **CE and CN**, the H₂ network is built entirely **endogenously** — the optimiser decides in every planning horizon which gas pipes to retrofit and which new H₂ pipelines to build, with no pre-committed infrastructure. Endogenous H₂ pipelines and gas-pipe retrofitting are **standard PyPSA-Eur v0.10.0 features**.

In **SE and SN**, the German *Wasserstoffkernnetz* ([FNB-Gas](#)) and the European [hydrogen infrastructure map](#) are layered on top as pre-committed infrastructure: the kernnetz pipelines themselves are fixed (non-extendable) until 2040, after which they become optimisable. Endogenous H₂ pipeline expansion and gas retrofitting remain active in all horizons, exactly as in CE and CN. This is a **PyPSA-IEI addition**, adapted from [PyPSA-Ariadne](#).

H₂ Pipeline Topology (all scenarios)

New H₂ pipeline candidates are generated by `create_network_topology()` using the combined corridor set of existing **AC/DC electricity lines** and **CH₄ gas pipelines**. This is not a free all-to-all graph — a candidate link is only created where transmission infrastructure already exists. The function is called in `add_storage_and_grids()` in `prepare_sector_network.py`:

scripts/prepare_sector_network.py

```
h2_pipes = create_network_topology(
    n, "H2 pipeline ", carriers=["DC", "gas pipeline"]
)
n.madd("Link", h2_pipes.index, ..., p_nom_extendable=True, carrier="H2 pipeline")
```

Gas-pipe retrofit candidates follow the same topology, with `p_nom_max = p_nom_CH4 × H2_retrofit_capacity_per_CH4` (default 0.6).

Wasserstoffkernnetz (SE / SN only)

SNAKEMAKE RULES

Rule	Script	Purpose
<code>build_wasserstoff_kernnetz</code>	<code>scripts/build_wasserstoff_kernnetz.py</code>	Process and merge FNB-Gas + ENTSO-G data
<code>cluster_wasserstoff_kernnetz</code>	<code>scripts/cluster_wasserstoff_kernnetz.py</code>	Map H ₂ network to model clusters
<code>modify_prenetwork</code>	<code>scripts/modify_prenetwork.py</code>	Integrate H ₂ pipelines into the network

DATA SOURCES

Source	File	Geographic scope
FNB-Gas	<code>Anlage2_Leitungsmeldungen_...xlsx</code> — pipeline submissions from potential operators	Germany
FNB-Gas	<code>Anlage3_FNB_Massnahmenliste_...xlsx</code> — FNB measure list (retrofit + new build)	Germany
ENTSO-G	<code>data/wasserstoff_kernnetz/h2_inframap_entsog.geojson</code>	Europe

The two FNB-Gas files are downloaded automatically by Snakemake at runtime from fnb-gas.de. Both datasets are merged in `cluster_wasserstoff_kernnetz`. Duplicate entries between the two sources are removed to prevent double-counting of pipeline capacities.

PIPE CAPACITY CALCULATION

H₂ pipe capacity is estimated from pipe diameter using piecewise linear interpolation across three reference points:

scripts/build_wasserstoff_kernnetz.py

```
def diameter_to_capacity_h2(pipe_diameter_mm):
    """
    20 inch (500 mm) 50 bar -> 1.2 GW H2 (LHV)
    36 inch (900 mm) 50 bar -> 4.7 GW H2 (LHV)
    48 inch (1200 mm) 80 bar -> 16.9 GW H2 (LHV)
    """
    m0 = (1200 - 0) / (500 - 0)
    m1 = (4700 - 1200) / (900 - 500)
    m2 = (16900 - 4700) / (1200 - 900)

    if pipe_diameter_mm < 500:
        return m0 * pipe_diameter_mm
    elif pipe_diameter_mm < 900:
        return m1 * pipe_diameter_mm + (1200 - m1 * 500)
    else:
        return m2 * pipe_diameter_mm + (4700 - m2 * 900)
```

For retrofitted pipes, the displaced gas capacity is also tracked using `diameter_to_capacity` (from `build_gas_network.py`) to reduce the gas network capacity accordingly.

INTEGRATION INTO THE NETWORK

PyPSA capacity parameters

- `p_nom` — nominal (installed) capacity of a link in MW.
- `p_nom_extendable` — if `True`, the optimizer decides the capacity; if `False`, it is fixed at `p_nom`.
- `p_nom_min` / `p_nom_max` — lower and upper bounds on the capacity the optimizer can choose. `p_nom_max = p_nom` means no expansion beyond current size; `p_nom_min = 0` means the link can be fully decommissioned.

H₂ pipeline data is integrated into the network in the `modify_prenetwork` rule via `add_wasserstoff_kernnetz()`. Only pipelines with `build_year` within the current investment period are added. The function also:

- **Reduces gas pipeline capacity** (`p_nom`) on routes where kernnetz pipelines have been retrofitted from gas
- **Reduces H₂ retrofitting potential** (`p_nom_max` on H₂ pipeline retrofitted links) for all kernnetz pipelines built to date

scripts/modify_prenetwork.py

```
# Reduce gas pipeline p_nom for retrofitted kernnetz pipes
gas_pipes = n.links.query("carrier == 'gas pipeline'")
res_gas_pipes = reduce_capacity(gas_pipes, add_reversed_pipes(wkn_to_date), carrier="gas")
n.links.loc[n.links.carrier == "gas pipeline", "p_nom"] = res_gas_pipes["p_nom"]

# Reduce H2 retrofitting potential for all kernnetz pipes built to date
res_h2_pipes_retrofitted = reduce_capacity(
    h2_pipes_retrofitted,
    add_reversed_pipes(wkn),
    carrier="H2",
    target_attr="p_nom_max",
    conversion_rate=snakemake.config["sector"]["H2_retrofit_capacity_per_CH4"],
)
```

How to Modify the Hydrogen Network

THE WASSERSTOFFKERNNETZ

The Wasserstoffkernnetz integration is controlled under `policy_plans` in the scenario config:

config/scenarios/config.SE.yaml

```
policy_plans:
  wasserstoff_kernnetz:
    enable: true
    optimize_after: 2040 # pipelines are non-extendable until this year
```


GAS-TO-H₂

Pipeline retrofitting is controlled separately under `sector:`:

config/config.agora.yaml

```
sector:  
  H2_retrofit: true  
  H2_retrofit_capacity_per_CH4: 0.6 # capacity ratio H2/CH4
```

4.3.3 CO₂ Pipeline Network

Overview

CO₂ pipeline transport is a standard feature of [PyPSA-Eur v0.10.0](#), retained unchanged in PyPSA-IEI. The CO₂ pipeline and submarine pipeline investment costs are overridden from the technology-data baseline — see [Costs](#) for details.

When both `co2_spatial: true` and `co2network: true` are set, the model builds an endogenously expandable CO₂ transport network. Each pipeline is a **bidirectional PyPSA Link** connecting per-node CO₂ storage tanks, whose candidate routes are derived automatically from the existing electricity transmission topology. This allows the optimiser to decide where captured CO₂ is temporarily stored, transported between nodes, and ultimately sequestered underground — rather than assuming a single, spatially aggregated CO₂ pool.

Snakemake Rule

Rule: `prepare_sector_network`

Script: `scripts/prepare_sector_network.py`

Two functions are called in sequence:

Function	Purpose
<code>add_co2_tracking()</code>	Adds atmospheric and regional CO ₂ buses, short-term storage tanks, sequestration stores, and optional vent links
<code>add_co2_network()</code>	Derives candidate pipeline routes from the electricity network and adds bidirectional pipeline links

Network Topology

Pipeline routes are derived automatically — no separate pipeline dataset is required.

`create_network_topology()` scans all AC lines and DC links in the network, groups connections by unique node-pair, and averages their `length` and `underwater_fraction`:

scripts/prepare_sector_network.py

```
co2_links = create_network_topology(n, "CO2 pipeline ")
```

The resulting pipeline names follow the pattern `CO2 pipeline <nodeA> -> <nodeB>`. Connections where both ends belong to the same node are dropped automatically.

Cost Calculation

Capital cost per pipeline route combines separate onshore and submarine cost rates weighted by the route's `underwater_fraction`:

scripts/prepare_sector_network.py

```
cost_onshore = (
    (1 - co2_links.underwater_fraction)
    * costs.at["CO2 pipeline", "fixed"]
    * co2_links.length
)
cost_submarine = (
    co2_links.underwater_fraction
    * costs.at["CO2 submarine pipeline", "fixed"]
    * co2_links.length
)
capital_cost = cost_onshore + cost_submarine
capital_cost *= snakemake.config["sector"]["co2_network_cost_factor"]
```

Parameter	Source
CO2 pipeline fixed cost (€/MW/km/yr)	data/costs_<year>.csv — overridden, see Costs
CO2 submarine pipeline fixed cost (€/MW/km/yr)	data/costs_<year>.csv — overridden, see Costs
CO2 pipeline lifetime (years)	data/costs_<year>.csv
co2_network_cost_factor	config.agora.yaml → sector:

Each pipeline is added as a fully bidirectional link (`p_min_pu=-1`), with capacity determined endogenously by the optimiser (`p_nom_extendable=True`):

scripts/prepare_sector_network.py

```
n.madd(
    "Link",
    co2_links.index,
    bus0=co2_links.bus0.values + " co2 stored",
    bus1=co2_links.bus1.values + " co2 stored",
    p_min_pu=-1, # bidirectional: negative flow = reversed direction
    p_nom_extendable=True,
    length=co2_links.length.values,
    capital_cost=capital_cost.values,
    carrier="CO2 pipeline",
    lifetime=costs.at["CO2 pipeline", "lifetime"],
)
```

Regional Sequestration Potential

Underground storage at `<node> co2 sequestered` is capped per node when `regional_co2_sequestration_potential.enable: true`. Geological potentials are sourced from the [CO2Stop database](#) (European Commission) and spatially overlaid with model regions in `scripts/`

`build_sequestration_potentials.py`. Per-node limits are clipped to `max_size` and divided by `years_of_storage` to convert a total geological capacity into an annual flow rate:

scripts/prepare_sector_network.py

```
e_nom_max = (
    e_nom_max
    .reindex(spatial.co2.locations)
    .fillna(0.0)
    .clip(upper=upper_limit) # max_size in Mt
    .mul(1e6)                # Mt → t
    / annualiser              # total capacity → annual rate
)
```

Config key	Value	Meaning
<code>regional_co2_sequestration_potential.enable</code>	<code>true</code>	Apply per-node sequestration caps
<code>regional_co2_sequestration_potential.attribute</code>	<code>'conservative estimate Mt'</code>	Column from CO2Stop dataset to use
<code>regional_co2_sequestration_potential.include_onshore</code>	<code>true</code>	Include onshore geological formations
<code>regional_co2_sequestration_potential.min_size</code>	3	Minimum site size to include (Mt CO ₂)
<code>regional_co2_sequestration_potential.max_size</code>	25	Hard upper cap per node (Mt CO ₂)
<code>regional_co2_sequestration_potential.years_of_storage</code>	25	Annualisation divisor
<code>co2_sequestration_cost</code>	10	Cost (€/t CO ₂)
<code>co2_sequestration_lifetime</code>	50	Lifetime (years)

Configuration

config/config.agora.yaml

```
sector:
  co2_spatial: true          # enable per-node CO2 buses (required for CO2 network)
  co2network: true           # add CO2 pipeline links
  co2_network_cost_factor: 1 # cost multiplier (1 = unchanged)
  co2_vent: true             # allow venting of stored CO2 back to atmosphere
  regional_co2_sequestration_potential:
    enable: true
    attribute: 'conservative estimate Mt' # column from CO2Stop dataset
    include_onshore: true                 # include onshore formations
    min_size: 3                           # minimum site size (Mt CO2)
    max_size: 25                           # upper cap per node (Mt CO2)
    years_of_storage: 25                   # annualisation divisor
  co2_sequestration_potential: 500 # fallback global cap (Mt/yr) if regional disabled
  co2_sequestration_cost: 10        # €/t CO2
  co2_sequestration_lifetime: 50    # years
```

How to Modify the CO₂ Network

DISABLE CO₂ PIPELINES WHILE KEEPING SPATIAL TRACKING

```
sector:
  co2_spatial: true
  co2network: false # each node stores CO2 independently, no transport
```

DISABLE SPATIAL CO₂ TRACKING ENTIRELY

```
sector:
  co2_spatial: false # all CO2 collapses to a single EU-level bus
  co2network: false
```

SCALE ALL PIPELINE COSTS

```
sector:
  co2_network_cost_factor: 1.5 # 50% more expensive pipelines
```

REMOVE REGIONAL SEQUESTRATION CAPS

```
sector:
  regional_co2_sequestration_potential:
    enable: false
  co2_sequestration_potential: .inf # unlimited global sequestration
```

4.3.4 TYNDP Electricity Projects

Overview

TYNDP electricity transmission projects are enforced on the network in `prepare_sector_network`. Per-project capacity limits are read from two CSV files and applied for each planning horizon. Cross-border lines and links can optionally be made extendable from a given year onwards.

This covers **cross-border** TYNDP transmission projects. National (intra-country) transmission is handled separately via [National Grid Plans](#).

Snakemake Rule

Rule: `prepare_sector_network`

Script: `scripts/prepare_sector_network.py` — function `set_capacity_tyndp_elec()`

Input data:

- `data/links_2020-2050.csv` — DC link capacity limits per year
- `data/lines_2020-2050.csv` — AC line capacity additions per year and TYNDP status

Scenario Behaviour

Scenario	TYNDP statuses included	Cross-border extendable from
CE, CN	<code>under construction</code>	All horizons (<code>optimize_after: true</code>)
SE, SN	<code>in planning</code> , <code>in permitting</code> , <code>under construction</code>	2040 onwards (<code>optimize_after: 2040</code>)

CSV Data Format

PyPSA capacity parameters

- `p_nom` — nominal (installed) capacity of a component in MW.
- `p_nom_extendable` — if `True`, the optimizer decides the capacity; if `False`, it is fixed at `p_nom`.
- `p_nom_min` / `p_nom_max` — lower and upper bounds on the capacity the optimizer can choose. Setting both equal to `p_nom` fixes the capacity; setting only `p_nom_min` leaves it extendable without an upper limit.

`data/links_2020-2050.csv`

Columns: `name`, `bus0`, `bus1`, `p_nom`, `2020`, `2025`, ..., `2050`

Each year column contains a fraction of `p_nom` or the special keyword `opt` (= set a soft minimum and leave the link extendable without an upper bound):

Value	Effect
0.0	Link not active in this year
1 (float > 0)	<code>p_nom_min = p_nom_max = p_nom × value</code> , link made extendable
opt	<code>p_nom_min = p_nom</code> , link remains extendable without upper bound

`data/lines_2020-2050.csv`

Columns: `name`, `bus0`, `bus1`, then one column per `{year}{status}` combination (e.g., `2025under construction`, `2030in planning`).

Each cell holds the capacity addition [MW] for that year and status, or `opt` for a soft minimum (extendable without upper bound). Values with an `opt` suffix set the minimum and leave the line extendable.

Configuration

TYNDP electricity enforcement is disabled by default and enabled per scenario:

config/config.agora.yaml

```
policy_plans:
  include_tyndp_elec:
    enable: false          # set to true in scenario configs
    allowed_statuses:
      - under consideration
      - in planning
      - in permitting
      - under construction
    optimize_after: true   # true = all horizons; integer year = from that year
```

config/scenarios/config.CE.yaml

```
policy_plans:
  include_tyndp_elec:
    enable: true
    allowed_statuses:
      - under construction
    # optimize_after inherits true from base config
```

config/scenarios/config.SE.yaml

```
policy_plans:
  include_tyndp_elec:
    enable: true
    allowed_statuses:
      - in planning
      - in permitting
      - under construction
    optimize_after: 2040
```

How to Change the TYNDP enforcement

CONFIGURE WHICH TYNDP PROJECTS ARE ENFORCED

Edit `policy_plans.include_tyndp_elec.allowed_statuses` in the scenario config. Only projects whose TYNDP status tag matches an entry in this list are enforced.

CONFIGURE WHEN CROSS-BORDER LINKS BECOME EXTENDABLE

Set `policy_plans.include_tyndp_elec.optimize_after` to `true` (all horizons) or to an integer year (e.g., `2040`) in the scenario config.

MODIFY CAPACITY VALUES PER HORIZON

Edit the year columns in `data/links_2020-2050.csv` (DC links) or the `{year}{status}` columns in `data/lines_2020-2050.csv` (AC lines).

4.3.5 National Grid Expansion Plans

Overview

National electricity transmission expansion is constrained based on country-specific grid expansion plans (e.g., from Ember study). The feature limits national AC line and DC link expansion to specified factors relative to base year capacities.

This applies only to **national** (intra-country) transmission infrastructure. Cross-border TYNDP projects are handled separately via the [TYNDP Electricity Projects](#) functionality.

Snakemake Rule

Rule: `solve_elec_networks` / `solve_sector_networks`

Script: `scripts/solve_network.py` — `function add_national_grid_plan_constraints()`

Input data:

- `data/national_line_expansions.csv` — Expansion factors per country and year

Scenario Behaviour

The constraint is disabled by default and enabled per scenario via `solving.constraints.national_grid_plans: true`. The `optimize_after` parameter controls from which planning horizon national grids become freely extendable (no longer bound by the CSV expansion factors).

Scenario	Constraint active	<code>optimize_after</code>	Effect
CE	No	—	No national expansion limit applied
CN	No	—	No national expansion limit applied
SE	Yes	2040	Expansion capped by CSV factors; freely extendable from 2040
SN	Yes	2040	Expansion capped by CSV factors; freely extendable from 2040

PyPSA capacity parameters

PyPSA uses different capacity attributes depending on component type:

- `p_nom` — nominal power capacity of a **Link** (DC line, converter, etc.) in MW. `p_nom_opt` is the value chosen by the optimizer; `p_nom_min` / `p_nom_max` are the bounds.
- `s_nom` — nominal apparent power capacity of a **Line** (AC transmission) in MVA. `s_nom_opt` is the optimized value; `s_nom_min` / `s_nom_max` are the bounds.
- `s_max_pu` — per-unit loading limit on a Line (typically 0.7), so effective capacity = `s_nom × s_max_pu`.
- `p_nom_extendable` / `s_nom_extendable` — if `True`, the optimizer decides the capacity.

Base year capacities: The reference capacities that factors are applied to are derived from the optimized network of the **first planning horizon** (e.g. 2020). They are computed by `extract_base_year_capacities()` in `scripts/add_brownfield.py` when preparing the second planning horizon, summing national AC line (`s_nom_opt × s_max_pu`) and DC link (`p_nom_opt`) capacities per country, and saved to `results/.../base_year_capacities/`. The constraint then enforces `factor × base_capacity`.

Factor selection per country: For each country, the code searches the CSV for data years that fall in the window `(previous_horizon, current_horizon]`. The most recent year within that window is used as the expansion factor. Countries with no data in that window are excluded from the constraint.

Fallback when no country has data in the window (e.g. all countries lack CSV entries for this period):

Case	Condition	Behavior
1A — Before data range	Current year < first CSV year, and not the first planning horizon	National transmission fixed at current capacity (except TYNDP-committed projects)
1B — First planning horizon	Current year is the first in <code>planning_horizons</code>	All national transmission freely extendable
1C — Beyond data range	Current year > last CSV year (and not first horizon)	Controlled by <code>optimize_after</code> setting

CSV Data Format

`data/national_line_expansions.csv`

Columns: Country ISO2 code as row index, year columns (e.g., `2026`, `2030`, ...):

```
country,2026,2030
DK,1.44,
EE,1.17,1.24
GR,1.16,1.35
DE,1.09,1.2
FR,1.01,1.02
PL,1.12,1.24
LV,1.0,1.0
```

Each cell contains the **expansion factor** (float) relative to base year capacity:

Value	Meaning
1.0	No expansion allowed beyond base year (e.g. LV)
1.09	9% expansion allowed (e.g. DE in 2026)
1.44	44% expansion allowed (e.g. DK in 2026)
Empty/NaN	Fallback behavior applies (e.g. DK in 2030)

Configuration

Default values in `config/config.agora.yaml` — the constraint is off by default:

config/config.agora.yaml

```
policy_plans:
  include_national_grid_plans:
    national_grid_plan_data: data/national_line_expansions.csv
    national_expansion_condition: equal # 'min', 'max', or 'equal'
    optimize_after: true # true = freely extendable at all horizons (no cap once constraint is off)

solving:
  constraints:
    national_grid_plans: false # disabled by default; enable per scenario
```

Overrides in SE and SN scenarios — these are the only two scenarios with the constraint active:

config/scenarios/config.SE.yaml | config/scenarios/config.SN.yaml

```
policy_plans:
  include_national_grid_plans:
    optimize_after: 2040 # expansion capped by CSV factors until 2040, freely extendable from 2040

solving:
  constraints:
    national_grid_plans: true
```

Parameter	Options	Description
<code>national_grid_plan_data</code>	File path	CSV with expansion factors per country/year
<code>national_expansion_condition</code>	<code>min</code> , <code>max</code> , <code>equal</code>	Constraint type: $\geq$, $\leq$, or $=$
<code>optimize_after</code>	<code>true</code> or integer	When national grids become freely extendable
<code>national_grid_plans</code> (in solving)	Boolean	Enable/disable constraint per scenario

Constraint type behavior:

- `equal` (default): National capacity must equal factor $\times$ base capacity
- `min`: National capacity at least factor $\times$ base capacity (allows more)
- `max`: National capacity at most factor $\times$ base capacity (caps expansion)

How to Modify

CHANGE EXPANSION FACTORS PER COUNTRY/YEAR

Edit `data/national_line_expansions.csv` with country-specific factors.

ADJUST CONSTRAINT TYPE

Set `national_expansion_condition` to `min`, `max`, or `equal` in config.

CONTROL WHEN NATIONAL GRIDS BECOME FREELY EXTENDABLE

Set `optimize_after` to `true` (always) or integer year (e.g., `2040`).

ENABLE/DISABLE PER SCENARIO

Set `solving.constraints.national_grid_plans: true` in scenario config.



Interaction with TYNDP

National grid plans apply **after** TYNDP electricity constraints. Lines/links already fixed by TYNDP (where `p_nom_min = p_nom_max` or `s_nom_min = s_nom_max`) are excluded from national grid constraints, ensuring TYNDP commitments take precedence.



Data Source

Default factors based on [Ember transmission grids study](#).

4.3.6 Import Infrastructure Retrofitting

Overview

Allows **retrofitting of existing natural gas import infrastructure** (both pipelines and LNG terminals) to hydrogen, and enables **dual use** of gas infrastructure by syngas. This constraint models the reuse of import capacity as energy carriers transition from fossil to renewable/synthetic fuels.

Two types of infrastructure can be retrofitted or shared:

1. **Pipeline imports:** CH₄ pipelines → H₂ pipelines
2. **LNG terminals:** Liquefied natural gas → Liquefied hydrogen

Additionally, natural gas infrastructure can be **dual-used** by syngas without retrofitting.

Scenario Behavior: This constraint is **always enabled for all scenarios** and applies automatically wherever import generators for multiple gas types exist at the same location. Unlike other constraints, it cannot be disabled via scenario configuration.

Snakemake Rule

Script: `scripts/solve_network.py` — function `add_import_retrofit_constraint`, called from `extra_functionality`

Rule: `solve_sector_network_myopic`

How It Works

PIPELINE RETROFITTING

For locations where both `import pipeline gas` and `import pipeline-H2` generators exist (same cluster), the following constraint applies:

Constraint:

$\text{CH}_4 \text{ capacity} + (\text{H}_2 \text{ capacity} / \text{retrofit factor}) = \text{Initial CH}_4 \text{ capacity}$

Where:

- CH₄ capacity = optimized natural gas pipeline capacity
- H₂ capacity = optimized hydrogen pipeline capacity
- Retrofit factor = `H2_retrofit_capacity_per_CH4` (default: 0.6)
- Initial CH₄ capacity = existing natural gas pipeline capacity (`p_nom_max`)

Interpretation: 1 MW of CH₄ pipeline can transport 0.6 MW of H₂ after retrofitting (due to lower volumetric energy density). Total usage cannot exceed the original CH₄ capacity in energy-equivalent terms.

LNG TERMINAL RETROFITTING

For locations with both `import lng gas` and `import shipping-H2 (retrofitted)`:

Constraint:

LNG capacity + Liquefied H₂ capacity = Initial LNG capacity

LNG terminals can be split between natural gas and liquefied hydrogen imports, with total capacity constrained to the original LNG terminal size.

DUAL USE BY SYNGAS

Natural gas pipelines and LNG terminals can be **simultaneously used** by syngas without capacity conversion factors:

Pipelines:

At each time step: CH₄ dispatch + Syngas dispatch ≤ CH₄ installed capacity

LNG terminals:

At each time step: LNG dispatch + Syngas-shipping dispatch ≤ LNG installed capacity

Additionally, the installed capacity of syngas import generators is set equal to the natural gas capacity to enable dual use.

Config

```
sector:
  H2_retrofit_capacity_per_CH4: 0.6 # 1 MW CH4 → 0.6 MW H2
```

`H2_retrofit_capacity_per_CH4`: Ratio of hydrogen transport capacity to methane capacity after retrofitting a pipeline (unitless, typically 0.5–0.7 due to H₂'s lower volumetric energy density).

How to Modify

CHANGE H₂ RETROFIT EFFICIENCY

```
sector:
  H2_retrofit_capacity_per_CH4: 0.5 # more conservative (1 MW CH4 → 0.5 MW H2)
```

DISABLE RETROFITTING (NOT RECOMMENDED)

The constraint is automatically applied where import generators exist. To effectively disable:

1. Remove H₂ import generators from `data/import_nodes_tech_manipulated_s_62_<year>.csv`, or
2. Remove `add_import_retrofit_constraint(n)` call from `extra_functionality` in `solve_network.py` (modifies core code)

4.4 Demand & Supply

4.4.1 Industrial Energy Demand

Overview

Industry demand is updated from the standard PyPSA-Eur values using data from the [TransHyDe](#) project. Two modifications are made relative to base PyPSA-Eur:

1. **Carrier ratios** for high-temperature processes are remapped to hydrogen to better reflect intra-country spatial distribution
2. **Absolute country totals** are scaled to match TransHyDe demand values

Snakemake Rules

Rule	Script	Purpose
<code>build_industry_sector_ratios</code>	<code>scripts/build_industry_sector_ratios.py</code>	Set carrier ratios per industry sector
<code>build_industrial_energy_demand_per_node</code>	<code>scripts/build_industrial_energy_demand_per_node.py</code>	Scale absolute demands to TransHyDe totals

Demand Scenarios

Three demand scenarios are defined in `build_industry_sector_ratios.py`:

<code>demand_scenario</code>	Description
<code>original</code>	Reverts to base PyPSA-Eur v0.10.0 carrier ratios
<code>high-temperature</code>	Hydrogen replaces fossil fuels in furnaces and smelters — reflects TransHyDe Scenario 1.5 (Mid Demand)
<code>high-temperature+steam</code>	As above, plus hydrogen replaces steam processing — reflects TransHyDe Scenario 2 (High Demand)

The carrier ratio scenario is selected via `transhyde_processes` in the config:

config/config.agora.yaml

```
industry:
  transhyde_data: true
  transhyde_processes: high_temp_only # use "high-temperature" ratios
  transhyde_scenario: 1.5             # selects input CSV: TH_S1.5_demand.csv
```

`transhyde_scenario` (1.5 or 2) and `transhyde_processes` are **independent**: `transhyde_scenario` selects which TransHyDE CSV is loaded for absolute demand scaling; `transhyde_processes` controls carrier ratios. They can be combined freely — for example, the `CE_TranshydeS2` scenario uses `transhyde_scenario: 2` with the default `transhyde_processes: high_temp_only`.

Hydrogen Demand Distribution

When `transhyde_data: true`, carrier ratios for high-temperature industrial processes (furnaces, smelters) are remapped to hydrogen. This only affects **spatial distribution** within a country — the absolute country totals are overwritten in the next step. From the script docstring:

When `transhyde_data` is True, processes (mostly heat) are mapped from originally electricity/biomass/gas to hydrogen. The mapping is not precise; the aim is to get a more realistic distribution of the demand within a country.

Scaling to TransHyDe Totals

`build_industrial_energy_demand_per_node` reads TransHyDe CSV data and scales PyPSA-Eur's country-level totals to match. The scaling preserves the intra-country distribution from `build_industry_sector_ratios`:

scripts/build_industrial_energy_demand_per_node.py

```
# Calculate per-carrier scaling factor: TransHyDe total / PyPSA total
factor = (demand_th_p / nodal_df_grp_m).fillna(1.0)

# Apply factor to all nodes, preserving intra-country distribution
nodal_df *= factor

# Where PyPSA has zero demand but TransHyDe has non-zero,
# distribute TransHyDe total using node weights
```

The TransHyDe data files are in `data/transhyde/`.

Ammonia and Methanol Imports

The model can reduce industrial energy demand when ammonia or methanol are imported rather than produced domestically. Both are disabled by default:

config/config.agora.yaml

```
sector:
  ammonia: false
  ammonia_import: false
  ammonia_import_share: 50 # % of demand met by imports, if enabled
  methanol_import: false
  methanol_import_share: 50 # % of demand met by imports, if enabled
```

How to Change the TransHyDe Scenario

Set `transhyde_processes` to control carrier ratios, and `transhyde_scenario` to select the input CSV for absolute scaling:

```
industry:
  transhyde_processes: high_temp_only # default; or: with_steam
  transhyde_scenario: 1.5 # default (Mid Demand); or: 2 (High Demand)
```

4.4.2 Energy Imports

Overview

Energy imports are modelled as **extendable generators** (with supporting buses and links where needed), covering five import technologies: hydrogen (pipeline and shipping), syngas (pipeline and shipping), and synfuel. Import capacities, costs, and node assignments are loaded from a planning-year-specific CSV file derived from the [TransHyDe project](#).

Snakemake Rule

Rule: `prepare_sector_network`

Script: `scripts/prepare_sector_network.py` — function `add_import()`

Data: `data/import_nodes_tech_manipulated_s_62_<year>.csv`

Import Technologies

Technology	Components added	Carrier
pipeline-H2	Generator → {node} H2 bus	<code>import pipeline-H2</code>
shipping-H2	Generator → {node} H2 bus	<code>import shipping-H2</code>
pipeline-syngas	Bus (syngas) + Generator + Link (syngas→gas)	<code>import pipeline-syngas</code>
shipping-syngas	Generator → existing syngas bus + Link (syngas→gas)	<code>import shipping-syngas</code>
synfuel	Bus (synfuel) + Generator + Link (synfuel→EU oil)	<code>synfuel</code>

For H₂ (pipeline and shipping), only a generator is needed since H₂ buses already exist. For syngas and synfuel, an intermediate bus is created and a link converts to the model's gas/oil network with a **negative CO₂ efficiency** on the `co2 atmosphere` bus — this cancels out the emissions that would otherwise be attributed when the synthetic fuel is eventually consumed.

Implementation

H₂ (pipeline and shipping) — generator only, injecting directly into the node's existing H₂ bus. Shipping routes include `shipping_idx` in the component name to distinguish multiple routes to the same node:

`scripts/prepare_sector_network.py`

```
# pipeline-H2: generator → {node} H2
n.madd(
    "Generator",
    [f"{node} {tech}" for node, tech in zip(import_nodes_tech_manipulated_pipeline_h2["bus"],
```

```

import_nodes_tech_manipulated_pipeline_h2["tech"]]],
bus=[f"{node} H2" for node in import_nodes_tech_manipulated_pipeline_h2["bus"]],
carrier=[f"import {tech}" for tech in import_nodes_tech_manipulated_pipeline_h2["tech"]],
p_nom_extendable=True,
p_nom_max=[f"{p_nom}" for p_nom in import_nodes_tech_manipulated_pipeline_h2["p_nom"]],
marginal_cost=[f"{marginal_cost}" for marginal_cost in import_nodes_tech_manipulated_pipeline_h2["marginal_cost"]],
capital_cost=[f"{capital_cost}" for capital_cost in import_nodes_tech_manipulated_pipeline_h2["capital_cost"]],
p_min_pu=0,
lifetime=25,
)

# shipping-H2: same structure, shipping_idx appended to name
n.madd(
    "Generator",
    [f"{node} {tech} ({shipping_idx})" for node, tech, shipping_idx in zip(
        import_nodes_tech_manipulated_shipping_h2["bus"],
        import_nodes_tech_manipulated_shipping_h2["tech"],
        import_nodes_tech_manipulated_shipping_h2["shipping_idx"])],
    bus=[f"{node} H2" for node in import_nodes_tech_manipulated_shipping_h2["bus"]],
    carrier=[f"import {tech}" for tech in import_nodes_tech_manipulated_shipping_h2["tech"]],
    p_nom_extendable=True,
    p_nom_max=[f"{p_nom}" for p_nom in import_nodes_tech_manipulated_shipping_h2["p_nom"]],
    marginal_cost=[f"{marginal_cost}" for marginal_cost in import_nodes_tech_manipulated_shipping_h2["marginal_cost"]],
    capital_cost=[f"{capital_cost}" for capital_cost in import_nodes_tech_manipulated_shipping_h2["capital_cost"]],
    p_min_pu=0,
    lifetime=25,
)

```

Syngas (pipeline and shipping) — an intermediate `syngas` bus is created per node, then a link converts `syngas` → `gas` with `efficiency2=-CO2_intensity` on the `co2 atmosphere` bus:

scripts/prepare_sector_network.py

```

# syngas bus – created once for the union of pipeline-syngas and shipping-syngas nodes
n.madd(
    "Bus",
    [f"{node} syngas" for node in pd.concat([
        import_nodes_tech_manipulated_pipeline_syngas["bus"],
        import_nodes_tech_manipulated_shipping_syngas["bus"]
    ]).unique()],
    location=[f"{node}" for node in pd.concat([
        import_nodes_tech_manipulated_pipeline_syngas["bus"],
        import_nodes_tech_manipulated_shipping_syngas["bus"]
    ]).unique()],
    carrier="syngas",
    unit="MWh_LHV",
)

```

Synfuel — same pattern: `synfuel` bus → generator → link to `EU oil` with `efficiency2=-costs.at["oil", "CO2 intensity"]`.

Input CSV Format

`data/import_nodes_tech_manipulated_s_62_<year>.csv` — one row per import node and technology:

```

,bus,Hydrogen Derivate,p_nom,node,tech,shipping_idx,marginal_cost,capital_cost
0,IT1 2,0,36721.2,Pipeline Italien: p_nom=existing gas_pipeline*0.6,pipeline-H2,,97,2688.0
1,BE1 0,,18782.8,,pipeline-syngas,,163,0.0
15,BE1 0,,20780.2,,shipping-syngas,,163,0.0

```

```
47,EU,,inf,,synfuel,,161,0.0
48,BE1 0,Ammonia,23000.0,Zeebrugge New Molecules development,shipping-H2,new,99,8421.6
```

Column	Description
bus	Model cluster node (e.g. BE1 0 , DE1 1) or EU for European aggregate
Hydrogen Derivate	Hydrogen carrier type (e.g. Ammonia, LH2, LOHC)
p_nom	Maximum import capacity [MW]
note	Human-readable description of the import project(s) at this node
tech	Import technology string
shipping_idx	Unique index for shipping routes
marginal_cost	Variable cost [EUR/MWh]
capital_cost	Annualised investment cost [EUR/MW/year]

How to Modify Imports

IMPORT CAPACITIES AND COSTS

To change import capacities or costs, edit the relevant year file:

```
data/import_nodes_tech_manipulated_s_62_2030.csv
data/import_nodes_tech_manipulated_s_62_2035.csv
...
```

IMPORT NODES

To add a new import node, add a row with the correct bus name, technology, and capacity. Bus names must match nodes in the clustered network (`s_62` = 62-node clustering). To disable all imports, remove or comment out the `add_import(n)` call in `prepare_sector_network.py`.

4.5 Solver Constraints

4.5.1 Self-Sufficiency Constraints

Overview

Minimum and maximum self-sufficiency constraints can be enforced for energy carriers at the country, regional cluster, or EU-wide level. The constraint ensures that a specified fraction of total demand is met by domestic generation rather than imports.

Self-sufficiency is the ratio of local generation to total demand (local generation + net imports). For example, 70% self-sufficiency means that 70% of demand is met by domestic sources and 30% by imports.

The constraint is enforced on **annual energy** (MWh), not capacity. It applies to each planning year independently and accounts for:

- Domestic generation from all relevant technologies
- Cross-border electricity transmission (AC lines and DC links)
- Pipeline flows (hydrogen, synfuel)
- External imports from non-European regions

Snakemake Rule

Script: `scripts/solve_network.py` — function `add_self_sufficiency_constraints`, called from `extra_functionality`

Rule: `solve_sector_network_myopic`

Data file: `data/self_sufficiency_limits.csv` (configured via `policy_plans.self_sufficiency_limits`)

Scenario Behavior

Scenario	Enabled	Use case
CE, SE	No	Cross-border planning without self-sufficiency targets
CN, SN	Yes	National self-sufficiency targets enforced

Enable via scenario config:

```
solving:
  constraints:
    self_sufficiency: true
```

Supported Carriers

The constraint independently tracks self-sufficiency for three energy carriers:

Carrier	ID in CSV	Generation technologies	Import pathways
Hydrogen	H2	H2 Electrolysis, SMR, SMR CC	H2 pipelines, external imports
Electricity	AC	Solar, onwind, offwind, hydro, nuclear, fossil CHP, H2 fuel cells	AC lines, DC links
Synfuel	synfuel	Fischer-Tropsch, biomass to liquid	(compared to oil demand)

For **electricity**, generation from the following carriers is counted: - offwind-ac, offwind-dc, onwind, solar, solar rooftop, ror (run-of-river) - hydro (storage units) - Conventional plants: coal, lignite, OCGT, CCGT, nuclear, oil, allam - CHPs: gas and biomass variants (residential, services, urban central) - H2 conversion: H2 Fuel Cell, H2 turbine

For **hydrogen**, generation includes: - H2 Electrolysis (electrolyzers) - SMR, SMR CC (steam methane reforming with/without carbon capture)

For **synfuel**, the constraint compares: - Synfuel generation: Fischer-Tropsch, biomass to liquid - Oil demand: land transport oil, shipping oil, aviation kerosene, residential/services oil boilers, industrial naphtha, agriculture machinery oil

Constraint Levels

The function can apply constraints at **multiple levels**:

- Per-country** (ISO2 codes: FR, DE, IT, etc.)
Cross-border flows between countries count as imports/exports.
- Per-cluster** (cluster IDs like PL00, DE10, etc.)
Flows between clusters count as imports/exports, even within the same country.
- EU-wide** (EU identifier)
Aggregates generation and trade for all EU27 countries as a single entity.

Default configuration: The provided data/self_sufficiency_limits.csv contains only **country-level** and **EU-wide** constraints. Cluster-level constraints are technically supported by the code but not configured in the default dataset.

Minimum and Maximum Constraints

Both lower and upper bounds can be specified:

- **Minimum self-sufficiency** (`min` column): Enforces at least X% domestic generation
Local generation must be greater than or equal to (Total demand × min value).
- **Maximum self-sufficiency** (`max` column): Prevents over-generation (exports above threshold)
Local generation must be less than or equal to (Total demand × max value).

Leave `min` or `max` blank (or empty rows) for no constraint in that direction.

CSV Format

File: `data/self_sufficiency_limits.csv`

Column	Description
<code>country</code>	ISO2 country code (e.g. <code>DE</code> , <code>FR</code>), cluster ID (e.g. <code>PL0 0</code>), or <code>EU</code> for EU-wide
<code>carrier</code>	Carrier: <code>H2</code> , <code>AC</code> , or <code>synfuel</code>
<code>year</code>	Planning year (integer)
<code>min</code>	Minimum self-sufficiency as a fraction (e.g. <code>0.8</code> = 80%) — blank = no minimum
<code>max</code>	Maximum self-sufficiency as a fraction (e.g. <code>1.1</code> = 110%, allowing 10% net exports) — blank = no maximum

Default data (excerpt from `data/self_sufficiency_limits.csv`):

```
country,carrier,year,min,max
DE,AC,2030,0.8,1.1
DE,AC,2050,1.0,1.1
DE,H2,2030,0.7,1.1
EU,AC,2030,0.8,1.1
EU,H2,2030,0.7,1.1
```

In this default configuration: - All countries must produce $\geq 80\%$ of electricity demand in 2030 (increasing to 100% by 2050) - All countries must produce $\geq 70\%$ of H₂ demand (constant 2025–2050) - Maximum self-sufficiency is 110% (allowing 10% net exports) - EU-wide aggregates have the same targets as individual countries

Config

Base config location:

```
policy_plans:
  self_sufficiency_limits: data/self_sufficiency_limits.csv
```

Enable in scenario config:

```
solving:
  constraints:
    self_sufficiency: true
```

How to Modify

CHANGE EXISTING TARGETS

The default CSV contains uniform targets for all countries. To adjust, modify the `min` or `max` values for specific countries and years:

```
DE,H2,2030,0.8,1.1 # increase Germany's H2 target from 0.7 to 0.8
FR,AC,2050,0.9,1.2 # relax France's electricity target and allow more exports
```

ADD SELF-SUFFICIENCY TARGET FOR A NEW COUNTRY

Add rows for a country not in the default data:

```
CH,H2,2030,0.6,1.0
CH,AC,2030,0.85,1.1
```

CHANGE EU-WIDE ELECTRICITY TARGET

```
EU,AC,2050,0.75,1.0
```

EU must generate 75–100% of electricity demand in 2050 (no net imports, limited net exports).

RELAX CONSTRAINT FOR A SPECIFIC YEAR

Remove the corresponding row or leave both `min` and `max` blank:

```
FR,H2,2035,,
```

APPLY CLUSTER-LEVEL CONSTRAINTS

For finer-grained regional policy (not in default config):

```
PL0 0,AC,2030,0.9,
PL1 0,AC,2030,0.5,
```

Note: Cluster IDs must match the network clustering (e.g., `s_62` = 62 clusters) and follow the format `{country_code}{cluster_num} {sub_id}` with a space.

Notes

Energy vs. Capacity

Unlike the [expansion limits](#) which constrain installed **capacity** (MW), self-sufficiency constraints operate on annual **energy** (MWh) generation and demand.



External imports

External imports (from non-European regions) are represented by generators with carriers like `import pipeline-H2` and `import shipping-H2`. These count as imports for the purpose of self-sufficiency calculation.



Interaction with other constraints

Self-sufficiency constraints are independent of: - [Expansion limits](#) (capacity bounds per technology)

- [National grid plans](#) (transmission expansion factors)

- [TYNDP projects](#) (cross-border transmission projects)

All constraints are applied simultaneously during optimization.

4.5.2 Overall Minimum Capacities

Overview

Enforces minimum total installed capacity per carrier **across all nodes** in the model. Unlike per-country expansion limits, this constraint sets a floor on the **aggregate capacity** for specific generation technologies across the entire system (e.g., all of Europe).

Origin: This constraint is from **PyPSA-Eur**, where it was originally called "BAU" (business-as-usual). It has been renamed to `overall_min_capacities` for clarity, though the config parameter remains `BAU_mincapacities`.

This is useful for business-as-usual scenarios or policy mandates that require a minimum deployment of certain technologies regardless of where they are located.

Example: Enforce at least 100 GW of OCGT capacity across all nodes — the sum of OCGT capacity across all nodes must be $\geq 100,000$ MW.

Snakemake Rule

Script: `scripts/solve_network.py` — function `add_overall_min_capacities_constraints`, called from `extra_functionality`

Rule: `solve_sector_network_myopic`

Scenario Behavior

By default, this constraint is **disabled** in all scenarios.

Enable via scenario config:

```
solving:
  constraints:
    overall_min_capacities: true
```

How It Works

For each carrier specified in `electricity.BAU_mincapacities`:

1. Sum the extendable `p_nom` capacity across all generators with that carrier
2. Constrain the sum to be $\geq$ the specified minimum (in MW)

Only applies to **extendable generators**. Existing (non-extendable) capacity is excluded from the constraint.

Config

Add to your config (typically in a scenario file):

```
electricity:
  BAU_mincapacities:
    solar: 50000      # minimum 50 GW solar across all nodes
    onwind: 100000    # minimum 100 GW onshore wind
    OCGT: 20000       # minimum 20 GW OCGT
    offwind-ac: 0     # no minimum (can be omitted)
    offwind-dc: 0     # no minimum (can be omitted)

solving:
  constraints:
    overall_min_capacities: true
```

Format: Carrier name → minimum capacity in MW

How to Modify

ADD MINIMUM CAPACITY FOR A TECHNOLOGY

Add an entry to `electricity.BAU_mincapacities`:

```
electricity:
  BAU_mincapacities:
    nuclear: 50000    # enforce at least 50 GW nuclear across Europe
```

REMOVE A CONSTRAINT

Set to `0` or remove the carrier entry:

```
electricity:
  BAU_mincapacities:
    solar: 0          # no minimum solar requirement
```

DISABLE THE CONSTRAINT ENTIRELY

```
solving:
  constraints:
    overall_min_capacities: false
```

4.5.3 Capacity Reserve Margin

Overview

Enforces a **capacity reserve margin** as a percentage above peak demand, requiring sufficient dispatchable generation capacity to cover peak load plus a safety margin. Only **conventional (dispatchable) generation** counts toward the reserve; renewable and storage units are excluded.

Origin: This constraint is from **PyPSA-Eur**, where it was originally called "SAFE" (capacity reserve). It has been renamed to `capacity_reserve` for clarity.

This constraint models security-of-supply requirements or capacity markets where a minimum firm capacity must be maintained regardless of renewables penetration.

Example: 10% reserve margin means total conventional capacity must be $\geq 110\%$ of peak demand.

Snakemake Rule

Script: `scripts/solve_network.py` — function `add_capacity_reserve_constraints`, called from `extra_functionality`

Rule: `solve_sector_network_myopic`

Scenario Behavior

By default, this constraint is **disabled** in all scenarios.

Enable via scenario config:

```
solving:
  constraints:
    capacity_reserve: true
```

How It Works

1. Calculate peak demand as the maximum total load across all time steps
2. Apply reserve margin: Required capacity = Peak demand $\times$ (1 + margin)
3. Sum existing + extendable conventional generation capacity
4. Constrain: Total conventional capacity $\geq$ Required capacity

Conventional carriers are defined in `electricity.conventional_carriers`: - `nuclear`, `coal`, `lignite`, `oil`, `OCGT`, `CCGT`, `geothermal`, `biomass`

Excluded from the constraint:

- Renewable generators (solar, wind)

- Storage units (batteries, hydro)
- Transmission capacity

Config

Add to your config (typically in a scenario file):

```
electricity:
  capacity_reserve_margin: 0.1 # 10% reserve above peak demand
  conventional_carriers:
    - nuclear
    - oil
    - OCGT
    - CCGT
    - coal
    - lignite
    - geothermal
    - biomass

solving:
  constraints:
    capacity_reserve: true
```

capacity_reserve_margin: Fraction above peak demand (0.1 = 10%, 0.15 = 15%, etc.)

How to Modify

CHANGE THE RESERVE MARGIN

```
electricity:
  capacity_reserve_margin: 0.15 # increase to 15%
```

DEFINE WHICH CARRIERS COUNT AS "CONVENTIONAL"

Edit the list to include/exclude specific technologies:

```
electricity:
  conventional_carriers:
    - nuclear
    - CCGT # exclude OCGT and coal from reserve requirement
```

DISABLE THE CONSTRAINT

```
solving:
  constraints:
    capacity_reserve: false
```

4.5.4 Expansion Limits

Overview

Minimum and maximum capacity constraints are enforced for selected renewable and other carriers across European countries for each planning year. The constraints target **total cumulative installed capacity** per country and carrier. Existing (non-extendable) capacity is subtracted before the bound is applied to the extendable `p_nom` decision variable.

Snakemake Rule

Script: `scripts/solve_network.py` — function `add_country_carrier_limit_constraints`, called from `extra_functionality`

Rule: `solve_sector_network_myopic`

Data files: selected via `policy_plans.agg_p_nom_limits` in the scenario config

Scenario	Data file	Min/max band
CE, SE, and variants	<code>data/agg_p_nom_minmax_european.csv</code>	±20 %
CN, SN	<code>data/agg_p_nom_minmax_national.csv</code>	±15 %

Carriers and Components

Carrier	Component	Geographic scope	Years with data
<code>solar</code>	Generator	All modelled countries	2030, 2050
<code>onwind</code>	Generator	All modelled countries	2030, 2050
<code>offwind</code>	Generator	All modelled countries	2030, 2050
<code>H2 Electrolysis</code>	Link	European-wide (<code>Eur</code>) + Romania	2030
<code>gas for electricity</code>	Link	Poland (2020–2030), Romania (2020–2050)	varies
<code>co2 sequestered</code>	Store	Romania	2030–2050

`gas for electricity` is a **grouped carrier**: OCGT, CCGT, urban central gas CHP (and CHP CC), micro gas CHP variants, and `allam` are all counted together against this limit. For Links, the constraint is applied to output capacity (`p_nom × efficiency`), not input capacity.

CSV Format

Both files share the same long format: one row per (country, carrier, year) combination. Empty `min` or `max` cells mean no constraint for that direction.

Column	Description
country	ISO2 country code, or <code>Eur</code> for European-wide aggregate
carrier	Carrier name as it appears in the constraint (see grouping above)
year	Planning year (integer)
min	Minimum total installed capacity [MW or t for CO ₂] — blank = unconstrained
max	Maximum total installed capacity [MW or t for CO ₂] — blank = unconstrained
unit	Unit string (e.g. <code>MW</code> , <code>MW_H2</code> , <code>t</code>)
Source	Source reference
component	PyPSA component type in lowercase (<code>generator</code> , <code>link</code> , <code>store</code>)

Example rows:

```
country,carrier,year,min,max,unit,Source,component
DE,solar,2030,172000.0,258000.0,MW,Ember,generator
DE,solar,2050,9600.0,175423.9,MW,Atlite,generator
PL,gas for electricity,2025,,5500.0,MW,Forum Energii 2025/03/07,link
Eur,H2 Electrolysis,2030,46978.8,111532.4,MW_H2,IEA hydrogen map,link
RO,co2 sequestered,2030,,10000000.0,t,NZIA communicated by EPG,store
```

Config

```
policy_plans:
  agg_p_nom_limits: data/agg_p_nom_minmax_european.csv # default base config
```

Scenario configs override this key:

```
# config.CE.yaml / config.SE.yaml
policy_plans:
  agg_p_nom_limits: data/agg_p_nom_minmax_european.csv

# config.CN.yaml / config.SN.yaml
policy_plans:
  agg_p_nom_limits: data/agg_p_nom_minmax_national.csv
```

Note

The two files differ only in the $\pm\%$ band applied to the 2030 Ember/NECP targets: $\pm 20\%$ in the European file and $\pm 15\%$ in the national file. The 2050 upper bounds (Atlite technical potentials) and all non-renewable entries are identical.

How to Modify the Expansion Limits

CHANGE A CAPACITY LIMIT FOR A COUNTRY

Edit the relevant CSV directly. Each row is a single (country, carrier, year) entry. For example, to raise the solar minimum in Spain for 2030:

```
ES,solar,2030,130000.0,195000.0,MW,Custom,generator
```

ADD A CONSTRAINT TO NEW COUNTRY OR CARRIER

Add a new row with `country`, `carrier`, `year`, `min/max`, and `component`. Make sure `carrier` matches the grouped name (e.g. use `offwind`, not `offwind-ac`) and `component` is lowercase.

ADD A EUROPEAN-WIDE CONSTRAINT

Use `Eur` as the `country` value. The code automatically duplicates every component into an `Eur` group and adds both country-level and European-level `p_nom` to the left-hand side of the constraint.

4.6 Optimization Settings

4.6.1 Myopic Optimization (Brownfield)

Overview

Myopic pathway optimization builds each planning horizon on top of the previous one. The `add_brownfield` rule manages this transition by:

1. Carrying forward previously built capacity (fixed, non-extendable)
2. Accounting for gas pipeline retrofitting to H₂
3. Adding newly commissioned powerplants
4. Updating import pipeline and terminal retrofit potentials

Snakemake Rule

Rule: `add_brownfield`

Script: `scripts/add_brownfield.py` — function `add_brownfield()`

1. Carrying Forward Previous Capacity

All assets (Generator, Link, Store) from the previous horizon that are still within their lifetime are imported into the current network with their **optimized capacity fixed** (non-extendable):

`scripts/add_brownfield.py`

```
for c in n_p.iterate_components(["Link", "Generator", "Store"]):
    # Remove assets that have expired
    n_p.remove(c.name, c.df.index[c.df.build_year + c.df.lifetime < year])

    # Remove assets below minimum capacity threshold
    n_p.remove(c.name, c.df.index[
        c.df[f"{attr}_nom_extendable"] & (c.df[f"{attr}_nom_opt"] < threshold)
    ])

    # Fix capacity at optimized value from previous horizon
    c.df[f"{attr}_nom"] = c.df[f"{attr}_nom_opt"]
    c.df[f"{attr}_nom_extendable"] = False

    n.import_components_from_dataframe(c.df, c.name)
```

2. Gas Pipeline Retrofitting

When `H2_retrofit: true`, existing gas pipeline capacity is reduced by the amount already retrofitted to H₂ in previous horizons:

scripts/add_brownfield.py

```
CH4_per_H2 = 1 / snakemake.params.H2_retrofit_capacity_per_CH4

# Already retrofitted H2 capacity from previous years
already_retrofitted = (
    n.links.loc[h2_retrofitted_fixed_i, "p_nom"]
    .rename(lambda x: x.split("-2")[0].replace(fr, to) + f"-{year}")
    .groupby(level=0).sum()
)

# Remaining gas capacity = original - retrofitted (adjusted for energy ratio)
remaining_capacity = (
    pipe_capacity - CH4_per_H2
    * already_retrofitted.reindex(pipe_capacity.index).fillna(0)
)
n.links.loc[gas_pipes_i, "p_nom"] = remaining_capacity
n.links.loc[gas_pipes_i, "p_nom_max"] = remaining_capacity
```

3. New Powerplants

A base powerplant network is loaded and newly commissioned plants are added for the current horizon:

scripts/add_brownfield.py

```
n_ppl = pypsa.Network(snakemake.input.base_powerplants)
all_years = snakemake.config["scenario"]["planning_horizons"]
previous_year = str(all_years[all_years.index(year) - 1])

for ppl_component in n_ppl.iterate_components(["Link", "Generator"]):
    # Select plants commissioned between previous and current year
    idx_ppl = ppl_component.df.index[
        ends_with_year(ppl_component.df.index)
        & (ppl_component.df.index.str[-4:] > previous_year)
        & (ppl_component.df.index.str[-4:] <= str(year))
    ]
    n.generators.loc[idx_ppl, 'p_nom'] = ppl_component.df.loc[idx_ppl, 'p_nom']
```

4. Import Pipeline and Terminal Retrofitting

The same retrofit logic is applied to non-European gas import pipelines and LNG terminals:

scripts/add_brownfield.py

```
# Remaining gas pipeline capacity after retrofit
remaining_capacity_pipes = (
    full_capacity_pipes
    - CH4_per_H2 * retrofitted_capacity_pipes
    .rename(lambda x: x[:5] + ' import pipeline gas')
    .groupby(level=0).sum()
)
n.generators.loc[filtered_natural_gas_pipes_i, 'p_nom_max'] = remaining_capacity_pipes

# Remaining H2 retrofit potential
remaining_capacity_pipes_retro = (
```

```

max_capacity_retrofit_pipes
- retrofitted_capacity_pipes
  .rename(lambda x: x[:-4] + str(year))
  .groupby(level=0).sum()
)
n.generators.loc[filtered_h2_pipes_ext_i, 'p_nom_max'] = remaining_capacity_pipes_retro

```

The same pattern applies to LNG → H₂ terminal retrofitting.

How to Configure

config/config.agora.yaml

```

sector:
  H2_retrofit: true           # enable gas-to-H2 retrofitting
  H2_retrofit_capacity_per_CH4: 0.6  # H2 capacity per CH4 capacity unit

existing_capacities:
  threshold_capacity: 10      # MW - assets below this are dropped

```

Planning horizons are defined in the scenario config:

config/scenarios/config.CE.yaml

```

scenario:
  planning_horizons: [2020, 2025, 2030, 2035, 2040, 2045, 2050]

```

4.6.2 Curtailment Mode

Overview

An optional solver feature that explicitly models renewable curtailment by adding virtual generators with negative costs. When enabled, all renewable generators are forced to track their maximum availability ($p_{\min_pu} = p_{\max_pu}$) and negative-cost virtual generators absorb excess electricity that cannot be consumed or stored.

This makes curtailment volumes directly visible in the optimization results, useful for analyzing renewable integration and grid flexibility constraints.

The feature is **disabled by default** and can be enabled in the config file.

Snakemake Rule

Rule: `solve_elec_networks` / `solve_sector_networks`

Script: `scripts/solve_network.py` — function `prepare_network()`

Implementation

PyPSA per-unit dispatch parameters

- `p_max_pu` — upper bound on dispatch in each time step, as a fraction of `p_nom` (e.g. `0.8` = the generator can produce at most 80% of its capacity in that hour). For renewables this is the availability profile.
- `p_min_pu` — lower bound on dispatch, also as a fraction of `p_nom`. Setting `p_min_pu = p_max_pu` forces the generator to run at exactly its available capacity (no curtailment allowed unless a curtailment generator absorbs the excess).

These are **time-varying dispatch bounds**, distinct from `p_nom_min` / `p_nom_max` which are bounds on the *installed* capacity chosen by the optimizer.

When enabled, curtailment is modeled explicitly rather than implicitly:

1. All renewable generators have their `p_min_pu` set equal to `p_max_pu` (forcing them to "commit" to their full available capacity)
2. Virtual curtailment generators are added at all AC buses with:
3. Negative marginal cost (-0.1 EUR/MWh) to incentivize curtailment
4. Negative dispatch range (`p_min_pu = -1`, `p_max_pu = 0`)
5. Large nominal capacity (1,000 GW)

This allows the optimizer to explicitly curtail renewables when grid constraints or storage limitations prevent full utilization, making curtailment volumes directly visible in the results.

CODE

scripts/solve_network.py

```

if solve_opts.get("curtailment_mode"):
    n.add("Carrier", "curtailment", color="#fedfed", nice_name="Curtailment")
    n.generators_t.p_min_pu = n.generators_t.p_max_pu
    buses_i = n.buses.query("carrier == 'AC'").index
    n.madd(
        "Generator",
        buses_i,
        suffix=" curtailment",
        bus=buses_i,
        p_min_pu=-1,
        p_max_pu=0,
        marginal_cost=-0.1,
        carrier="curtailment",
        p_nom=1e6,
    )

```

Configuration

The feature is controlled under `solving.options`:

config/config.agora.yaml

```

solving:
  options:
    curtailment_mode: false # boolean

```

How to Enable

To enable curtailment mode for a specific scenario:

- Edit config file** — Set `curtailment_mode: true` in `config/config.agora.yaml` under `solving.options`, or
- Override in scenario config** — Add the option to a scenario-specific YAML file if using scenario overrides

The feature applies to all planning years in the optimization run. Curtailment results will appear in the network outputs under the `curtailment` carrier and can be analyzed via:

- `n.generators_t.p` (negative values for curtailment generators)
- `n.statistics()` with carrier filtering
- Post-processing scripts that aggregate by carrier

5. Post-Analysis

5.1 Post-Analysis Overview

The post-analysis scripts are located in `scripts_analysis/` and are run **after** the PyPSA optimization is complete. The master script `analysis_main.py` orchestrates all analyses and produces plots and Excel files organized into timestamped output folders.

5.1.1 How to Run

```
cd scripts_analysis
python analysis_main.py
```

The script must be run from inside `scripts_analysis/` — `main_dir` is resolved automatically as the parent of the current working directory.

5.1.2 Output Structure

```
analysis_results_YYYYMMDD/
  ExogenousDemand/      ← transport demand plots
  Balances/              ← energy balance charts per carrier
  network_plots/         ← transmission network maps
  KPIs/                  ← installed capacity, GWkm, dispatch, summary KPIs
  self-sufficiency/      ← regional energy self-sufficiency
  costs/                 ← total system cost breakdown
  utilization/           ← transmission line utilization
  Import/                ← energy import volumes and costs
  balance_maps/          ← spatial energy balance maps
```

5.1.3 Analysis Modules

Output folder	Script	Function
ExogenousDemand/	exogenous_demand_analyses.py	get_transport_demand_plot()
Balances/	configurable_energy_balances.py	get_standard_balances()
network_plots/	plot_elec_network.py	plot_map_elec_years()
network_plots/	plot_h2_network.py	plot_h2_map_years()
network_plots/	plot_co2_network.py	plot_co2_map_years()
network_plots/	plot_ch4_network.py	plot_ch4_map_years()
network_plots/	compare_grids.py	plot_grid_comparisons()
KPIs/	installed_capacity.py	call_installed_capacity_plot()
KPIs/	plot_GWkm.py	plot_TWkm_all_carriers()
KPIs/	summary_KPIs.py	start_KPI_analysis()
KPIs/	plot_cases_KPIs.py	plot_case_study_KPIs()
KPIs/	plot_dispatch_barchart.py	plot_dispatch_barchart()
self-sufficiency/	regional_self_sufficiency_level.py	evaluate_self_sufficiency()
costs/	analyze_total_system_cost.py	analyze_system_cost()
utilization/	line_usage.py	evaluate_line_usage()
Import/	import_analysis.py	analyze_imports()
balance_maps/	plot_balance_map.py	plot_balance_map_years()

5.1.4 Country Scopes

Three country lists are defined in `analysis_main.py` :

Variable	Count	Countries	Used for
<code>countries</code>	33	EU + NO, GB, CH, Western Balkans	Full model scope
<code>eu27_countries</code>	25	EU27 excl. Malta, Cyprus	Network maps
<code>th_countries</code>	26	TransHyDE project countries	Import analysis

5.2 System Costs

5.2.1 Overview

Total system cost breakdown per scenario and planning year, covering capital and operational expenditure by technology group. Costs are shown both as annual values and as integrated cumulative costs from the start year to each planning horizon.

Script: `scripts_analysis/analyze_total_system_cost.py`

Function: `analyze_system_cost()`

Output: `costs/`

5.2.2 Output Files

File	Description
<code>infrastructure_capital_cost.png</code>	Capital costs of transmission infrastructure (electricity, H ₂ , gas, CO ₂)
<code>absolute_capital_cost.png</code>	Absolute capital costs by technology group across all scenarios
<code>residual_capital_cost_{sel_scen}_{scenario}.png</code>	Difference in capital costs vs <code>sel_scen</code> , one file per comparison scenario
<code>operational_costs.png</code>	Operational (marginal) costs by category across all scenarios and years
<code>residual_operational_costs_{sel_scen}_{scenario}.png</code>	Difference in operational costs vs <code>sel_scen</code> , one file per comparison scenario
<code>total_costs.png</code>	Total annualised costs (capex + opex) per scenario and year
<code>total_overinvestment.png</code>	System cost difference vs <code>sel_scen</code> (bn EUR/yr)
<code>integrated_total_costs.png</code>	Cumulative total costs from start year per scenario
<code>integrated_difference_costs.png</code>	Cumulative cost difference vs <code>sel_scen</code> (bn EUR)
<code>total_costs.xlsx</code>	Excel with annualised and integrated costs by category

 `sel_scen`

`sel_scen` is the primary scenario selected in `analysis_main.py`. It is used as the reference baseline for all residual and difference plots. Files containing `{sel_scen}` and `{scenario}` in their name are generated once per comparison scenario.

The Excel file is also automatically written into `KPIs/Summary-Results-KPIs.xlsx` if that file already exists.

5.2.3 Technology Mapping

Cost components are mapped to groups via:

```
scripts_analysis/Mapping_system_costs.csv
```

The groups used in plots are:

Group	Includes
infrastructure	AC/DC lines, H ₂ /gas/CO ₂ pipelines
power generation	Solar, wind, nuclear, hydro, etc.
heat generation	Heat pumps, boilers, CHPs
transformation	Electrolysers, methanisation, Fischer-Tropsch, etc.
import (capex)	Import infrastructure capital costs
import (opex)	Import fuel operational costs
operational costs	Fuel costs, VOM
others (capex/opex)	Remaining components

5.2.4 Backup Capacities

`backup_capas` is hardcoded in `analysis_main.py` (currently `True`). When `True` and the backup cost file exists, gas turbine backup capacity costs are added to `total_overinvestment.png` and `integrated_difference_costs.png`. If the file is missing, the flag is automatically set to `False` by the script.

The costs are read from:

```
{analysis_results_dir}/Balances/gas_turbine_backup_costs.xlsx
```

where `{analysis_results_dir}` is the dated output folder (e.g., `analysis_results_20260311/`).

Note

This file is produced by `get_standard_balances()` for the `gas` carrier. The Energy Balances analysis must run before System Costs when `backup_capas=True`.

5.3 Energy Balances

5.3.1 Overview

Supply and demand balance charts are produced for 6 carriers across three regions (all countries, EU27, and one configurable country) per scenario and year. Results are saved as PNG bar charts, interactive HTML timeseries, and Excel files.

Script: `scripts_analysis/configurable_energy_balances.py`

Function: `get_standard_balances()`

Output: `Balances/`

5.3.2 Carriers

Carrier	Description
electricity	High-voltage electricity
gas	Natural gas / methane
low voltage	Residential electricity distribution
H2	Hydrogen
heat	Decentral heat
urban central heat	District heating

5.3.3 Output Files

For each carrier, the following are produced under `Balances/`:

File / Folder	Description
<code>balance_{carrier}.xlsx</code>	Excel with supply/demand data per country and scenario
<code>gas_turbine_backup_capacities.xlsx</code>	Gas turbine backup capacity data (electricity carrier only)
<code>gas_turbine_backup_costs.xlsx</code>	Gas turbine backup cost data (electricity carrier only)
<code>bar_plots/</code>	PNG bar charts per region and scenario mode
<code>timeseries_plots_line_chart/</code>	Interactive HTML line charts (selectable scenario/year)
<code>timeseries_plots_stacked_bar_chart/</code>	Interactive HTML stacked bar chart + PNG per scenario/year

Bar plots are generated for three regions: **All** (33 countries), **EU27**, and the configured country (default `DE`).

5.3.4 Configuration

Country

`country_to_plot` is set in `analysis_main.py` (currently `"DE"`). Any ISO2 country code in the model scope can be used.

Scenario comparison mode

`compare_scenarios` controls whether all scenarios are overlaid in one plot (`True`) or plotted individually (`False`). In `analysis_main.py` it is set to `[True, False]` for all carriers, producing both plot styles. `urban central heat` only uses `[True]` because it is not meaningful to plot it per individual scenario.

PNG time-series resampling

PNG stacked area charts in `timeseries_plots_stacked_bar_chart/` show the January dispatch profile. By default the plots use **flexible time segments** from the model (e.g. 2190 segments for a segmented run), which renders very fast. Optionally the data can be resampled to hourly resolution first, producing a uniform x-axis — but this is significantly slower.

The behaviour is controlled by a module-level flag in `configurable_energy_balances.py` :

```
RESAMPLE_TIMESERIES_PNG = True # default: uniform hourly x-axis
```

Override it once at the top of `analysis_main.py` before any balances are computed:

```
ceb.RESAMPLE_TIMESERIES_PNG = False # fast: raw time segments
```

The current default in `analysis_main.py` is `False` (raw segments).

5.4 KPIs

5.4.1 Overview

Five functions produce key performance indicators covering installed capacity, infrastructure volume, dispatch, and summary system metrics.

5.4.2 Installed Capacity

Script: `installed_capacity.py`

Function: `call_installed_capacity_plot()`

Output: KPIs/

Installed capacity by technology, planning year, and scenario. Controlled by `plot_backup_capas` (boolean) in `analysis_main.py` to optionally include backup capacity.

Output files are produced for two scopes (`EU27` and `All`) and three capacity types (`generation` , `heat` , `storage`):

File	Description
<code>installed_{type}_capacities_{scope}.png</code>	All-scenario comparison chart
<code>installed_{type}_capacities_{scope}_{scenario}.png</code>	Per-scenario chart across years

5.4.3 Infrastructure Volume (TW·km)

Script: `plot_GWkm.py` **Function:** `plot_TWkm_all_carriers()` **Output:** KPIs/

Installed capacity × line length (TW·km) per carrier (electricity, H₂, CO₂, gas) across years and scenarios. Plots are produced for four regions: all modelled countries, EU27, Benelux, and the Baltic cluster.

File	Description
<code>TWkm_elec_{region}.png</code>	Electricity TW·km
<code>TWkm_H2_{region}.png</code>	Hydrogen TW·km
<code>TWkm_CO2_{region}.png</code>	CO ₂ TW·km
<code>TWkm_gas_{region}.png</code>	Gas TW·km

Regions: `europe` , `eu27` , `benelux` , `balticum` .

5.4.4 Summary KPIs

Script: `summary_KPIs.py` **Function:** `start_KPI_analysis()` **Output:** KPIs/

Comprehensive Excel workbook covering total costs, emissions, and system metrics per country, EU27, and selected nodes, across all scenarios and years.

File	Description
<code>Summary-Results-KPIs.xlsx</code>	Full KPI workbook

5.4.5 Case Study KPIs

Script: `plot_cases_KPIs.py` **Function:** `plot_case_study_KPIs()` **Output:** KPIs/

Bar charts (with cluster map insets) comparing offshore capacity, H₂ storage, CO₂ storage, and H₂ import across scenarios and years for two predefined regional clusters: `northsea` and `balticum`.

File	Description
<code>offshore_capacity_{cluster}.png</code>	Offshore installed capacity
<code>H2_storage_{cluster}.png</code>	H ₂ storage capacity
<code>CO2_storage_{cluster}.png</code>	CO ₂ storage capacity
<code>H2_import_{cluster}.png</code>	H ₂ import (North Sea cluster only)

5.4.6 Dispatch Barchart

Script: `plot_dispatch_barchart.py` — `plot_dispatch_barchart()`

Stacked bar chart of flexibility dispatch (storage, demand response, etc.) across scenarios and years. The `"flexibility"` argument selects the KPI type computed inside the script.

File	Description
<code>flexibility_dispatch.png</code>	Flexibility dispatch comparison

5.5 Exogenous Demand

5.5.1 Overview

Analysis of exogenous transport energy demand across planning years for a selected scenario. Transport demand is broken down by mode (aviation, shipping, land transport) and energy carrier (kerosene, oil, methanol, EV, fuel cell).

Results show total annual energy consumption (TWh) for each transport category, helping track the transition from fossil fuels to electrification and alternative fuels.

Script: `scripts_analysis/exogenous_demand_analyses.py`

Function: `get_transport_demand_plot()`

Output: `ExogenousDemand/`

5.5.2 Transport Categories

Mode	Carrier	Description
Aviation	Kerosene	Kerosene and sustainable aviation fuel (SAF)
Shipping	Oil	Conventional marine fuel oil
Shipping	Methanol	Methanol-based marine fuel
Land transport	Oil	Conventional fossil fuel vehicles
Land transport	EV	Battery electric vehicles
Land transport	Fuel cell	Hydrogen fuel cell vehicles

5.5.3 Output Files

File	Description
<code>Transport_demand_exogenous.png</code>	Stacked bar chart showing transport demand by mode and carrier across years
<code>Transport_demand_exogenous.xlsx</code>	Excel data with annual energy demand (TWh) per transport category

5.6 Import Analysis

5.6.1 Overview

Energy import volumes (TWh) per import technology across planning years and scenarios.

Script: `scripts_analysis/import_analysis.py`

Function: `analyze_imports()`

Output: `Import/`

5.6.2 Import Sets

Three sets of import carriers are evaluated independently:

Set	Carriers
<code>H2_import</code>	H ₂ pipeline, H ₂ shipping
<code>H2_derivate_import</code>	H ₂ pipeline, H ₂ shipping, syngas pipeline, syngas shipping, synfuel
<code>energy_import</code>	All of the above + coal, oil, uranium, LNG gas, pipeline gas

5.6.3 Output Files

For each import set the following files are saved to `Import/`:

File	Description
<code>plot_{scenario}_{set}.png</code>	Stacked bar chart per scenario across years
<code>plot_all_{set}.png</code>	Side-by-side comparison of all scenarios
<code>imports_{scenario}_TWh.xlsx</code>	Detailed time-series data per scenario

5.7 Self-Sufficiency

5.7.1 Overview

Regional energy self-sufficiency levels per country and planning year, showing the ratio of domestic generation to total demand. Analysis is performed for both hydrogen and electricity carriers across all EU27 countries plus surrounding regions.

The analysis is run pairwise: `sel_scen` is compared against each other scenario to produce difference maps.

Script: `scripts_analysis/regional_self_sufficiency_level.py`

Function: `evaluate_self_sufficiency()`

Output: `self-sufficiency/`

5.7.2 Carriers

Self-sufficiency is calculated independently for two carriers:

Carrier	Description
H2	Hydrogen self-sufficiency based on domestic generation vs demand
Electricity	Electricity self-sufficiency based on renewable generation vs demand

For each carrier, self-sufficiency accounts for: - Domestic generation (electrolysis for H₂, renewables for electricity) - Cross-border transmission (pipelines for H₂, AC/DC lines for electricity) - External imports (from outside Europe)

5.7.3 Output Files

For each scenario, year, and carrier, the following files are generated:

File	Description
<code>{carrier}_self-sufficiency_map_{scenario}_{year}.png</code>	Map showing self-sufficiency percentage per country
<code>{carrier}_self-sufficiency_{scenario}_{year}.png</code>	Bar chart comparing self-sufficiency across countries, with EU27 aggregate
<code>{carrier}_self-sufficiency_diff_{scenario1}_{scenario2}_{year}.png</code>	Difference map comparing two scenarios

Where `{carrier}` is either `h2` or `elec`.

 `sel_scen`

`sel_scen` is the primary scenario selected in `analysis_main.py`. Difference maps are produced comparing `sel_scen` against each other scenario.

5.7.4 Regions

Self-sufficiency is calculated for:

- All 25 EU27 countries (excl. Malta and Cyprus)
- EU27 aggregate
- Surrounding countries (Balkans, UK, Norway, Switzerland)

The bar charts include an exogenous minimum self-sufficiency constraint line for scenarios `CN` and `SN` (years after 2025).

5.8 Balance Maps

5.8.1 Overview

Spatial maps of energy balances overlaid on the European grid, produced for each carrier, scenario, and year. A second set of difference maps compares the selected reference scenario against all other scenarios.

Script: `scripts_analysis/plot_balance_map.py`

Function: `plot_balance_map_years()`

Output: `balance_maps/`

5.8.2 Carriers

Carriers are defined in `config/config.plotting.yaml` under `constants.kinds`:

Carrier	Description
<code>carbon</code>	Carbon flows (CO ₂ capture, stored and sequestered)
<code>co2</code>	CO ₂ emissions
<code>electricity</code>	Transmission level electricity (AC and DC)
<code>gas</code>	Natural gas / methane
<code>hydrogen</code>	Hydrogen

5.8.3 Output Files

For each carrier, scenario, and year one PNG is saved to `balance_maps/`:

File	Description
<code>{carrier}_{region}_balance_map_{scenario}_{year}.png</code>	Single-scenario balance map
<code>{carrier}_{region}_balance_map_{scen1} vs {scen2}_{year}.png</code>	What is additional in <code>scen1</code> relative to <code>scen2</code>
<code>{carrier}_{region}_balance_map_{scen2} vs {scen1}_{year}.png</code>	What is additional in <code>scen2</code> relative to <code>scen1</code>

5.8.4 Configuration

Region

`country_to_plot_networks` in `analysis_main.py` controls which region is plotted. It is set to `"EU27"` by default. Three regions have dedicated plot configurations in `config.plotting.yaml`:

Value	Description
<code>"EU27"</code>	EU-27 + neighbouring countries (default)
<code>"PL_and_Baltics"</code>	Poland and the Baltic states (not plotted)
<code>"Benelux"</code>	Belgium, Netherlands, Luxembourg (not plotted)

Any other value falls back to the `"EU27"` configuration.

Reference scenario

`sel_scen` is the reference scenario used for the difference maps. Each other scenario in `scenarios` is compared against it.

Note

`sel_scen` is set in `analysis_main.py` and shared with other analysis functions (system costs, self-sufficiency).

5.9 Network Maps

5.9.1 Overview

Four scripts produce per-year and per-scenario maps of European transmission infrastructure. A fifth script compares two scenarios side by side.

Output: `network_plots/`

5.9.2 Scripts

Script	Function	Network
<code>plot_elec_network.py</code>	<code>plot_map_elec_years()</code>	Electricity (AC lines + DC links)
<code>plot_h2_network.py</code>	<code>plot_h2_map_years()</code>	Hydrogen pipelines and storage
<code>plot_co2_network.py</code>	<code>plot_co2_map_years()</code>	CO ₂ pipelines
<code>plot_ch4_network.py</code>	<code>plot_ch4_map_years()</code>	Methane / gas pipelines
<code>compare_grids.py</code>	<code>plot_grid_comparisons()</code>	Scenario difference maps

5.9.3 Output Files

Electricity

File	Description
<code>elec_netexpansion_{scenario}_{year}.png</code>	Post-network + pre-network overlay
<code>pre_elec_netexpansion_{scenario}_{year}.png</code>	Net expansion (post – pre)

Hydrogen

File	Description
<code>h2_electrolysis_network_{scenario}_{year}.png</code>	Electrolysis capacity map
<code>h2_all_network_{scenario}_{year}.png</code>	Full H ₂ network
<code>h2_net_flows_network_{scenario}_{year}.png</code>	Net H ₂ flows
<code>h2_storage_{scenario}_{year}.png</code>	H ₂ storage capacity

CO₂ and Gas

File	Description
<code>co2_network_{scenario}_{year}.png</code>	CO ₂ pipeline network
<code>ch4_network_{scenario}_{year}.png</code>	Methane / gas pipeline network

Grid Comparisons

`plot_grid_comparisons()` runs for each scenario paired against `sel_scen`, producing electricity and H₂ difference maps per year:

File	Description
<code>diff_elec_{scen1}_{scen2}_{year}.png</code>	Electricity grid difference
<code>diff_H2_{scen1}_{scen2}_{year}.png</code>	H ₂ grid difference

5.9.4 Geographic Scope

All network maps use `country_to_plot_networks`, set to `"EU27"` in `analysis_main.py`.

5.10 Gas Pipeline Utilization

5.10.1 Overview

Gas pipeline utilization analysis showing how heavily CH₄ pipelines are used relative to their nominal capacity. Utilization rates are calculated as mean power flow divided by capacity across all timesteps, weighted by snapshot duration.

Maps visualize both capacity (linewidth) and utilization (color scale) for each corridor across planning years and scenarios.

Script: `scripts_analysis/line_usage.py`

Function: `evaluate_line_usage()`

Output: `utilization/`

5.10.2 Output Files

For each scenario and year combination:

File	Description
<code>ch4_utilization_map_{scenario}_{year}.png</code>	Map showing gas pipeline capacity (linewidth) and average utilization percentage (color)

5.10.3 Visualization Details

Pipeline Capacity (Linewidth) - Linewidth scaled by optimal pipeline capacity (`p_nom_opt`) - Pipelines below 100 MW threshold are not displayed - Bidirectional flows are aggregated

Utilization Rate (Color) - Color scale from red (low utilization) to green (high utilization) - Calculated as: mean absolute power flow / (capacity × availability) - Averaged across the full year weighted by snapshot duration

6. Release Notes

- Add missing data files to repository [PR #36](#)
- Add OETC toggle config option [PR #39](#)
- Add documentation on constraints and national grid expansion plan [PR #17](#)
- Add documentation on post-analysis scripts [PR #8](#)
- Fix path and add logging to post-analysis scripts [PR #6](#)
- Enable download of documentation as PDF using `mkdocs-to-pdf` and enable documentation preview in PRs [PR #14](#)
- Deploy documentation and add documentation preview [PR #7](#)
- Add documentation [PR #5](#)
- Apply `snakemake` fix to prevent "another PID running" gurobi issue [PR #3](#)
- Integrate OETC [PR #1](#)

7. Support & Reporting Issues

If you encounter a problem — whether during installation, while running the pipeline, or with unexpected results — please open an issue on the GitHub repository so the team can help.

Issues tracker: github.com/open-energy-transition/PyPSA-IEI/issues

For a general guide on how to create a GitHub issue, see the [official GitHub documentation](#).

7.1 When to Open an Issue

Open an issue for any of the following:

- **Installation failure** — conda environment creation errors, missing packages, or import errors
 - **Pipeline crash** — a Snakemake rule fails with an error traceback
 - **Wrong or unexpected results** — outputs that differ from the published study without an obvious explanation
 - **Missing or incorrect input data** — files that cannot be retrieved or produce errors when parsed
 - **Documentation problems** — unclear instructions, broken links, or missing information
-

7.2 What to Include in Your Report

A good issue report allows the team to reproduce and fix the problem quickly. Please include the following:

1. Environment information

```
conda activate pypsa-iei
conda list | grep -E "pypsa|snakemake|python|linopy|gurobi"
```

Also state your operating system (Windows / Linux / macOS) and version.

2. The error message *(recommended)*

If possible, copy the complete traceback from the terminal as text — this allows the team to search and analyse it directly. If that is not convenient, a screenshot of the terminal output is also acceptable.

For Snakemake errors, the most useful information is usually in the log file for the failing rule rather than the terminal itself:

```
cat logs/<rule_name>.log
```


3. The config file used

State which scenario config was used (e.g. `config/scenarios/config.SE.yaml`) and paste any relevant settings you modified.

4. Steps to reproduce *(optional — helpful for unexpected results)*

If the issue is not a straightforward crash, briefly describe what you did and what you expected to happen instead. For example, which planning horizon failed, or which config settings were changed.

5. Expected vs actual behaviour

Briefly state what you expected to happen and what actually happened.

7.3 Checking Existing Issues

Before opening a new issue, search the [existing issues](#) to see if your problem has already been reported or resolved.